

around the courtyard is a sherds scatter from the Persian period, and west of it a few Bronze Age sherds were collected. Apparently the architecture on the site all belongs to a late period, either Ottoman or the British Mandate. The site's ancient structures were dismantled, and their stones were used to build the house and courtyard.

**Pottery:** Early Bronze I – 5%; Middle Bronze II – 5%; Persian – 75%; Early Roman – 5%; Ottoman and Modern – 10%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Bibliography:** Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 76.



Site 73: 17-20/58/1

## Wa'aret et-Tin

Israel grid: 1751 2086

UTM grid: 7128 5952

Elevation: 205 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: saddle on  
mountainous plateau

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Ḥanuni (no. 157),  
1.2 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), 1.3 km  
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: June 1979; Sept. 1998;  
32 sherds

A small site on a saddle between the el-Ḥuwwar Range and the hills of Wa'aret et-Tin, with a good view of the area nearby and the Jezreel Valley, about 1 km south-west of Kafr Dan.

There is a building (farmhouse?) on the site that includes a large courtyard, of which the southern and a western wings, arranged perpendicularly to each other, have been preserved. Of the eastern wing only a wall that reaches and ends at an entrance has survived. The entire northern wing and part of the eastern one are gone.

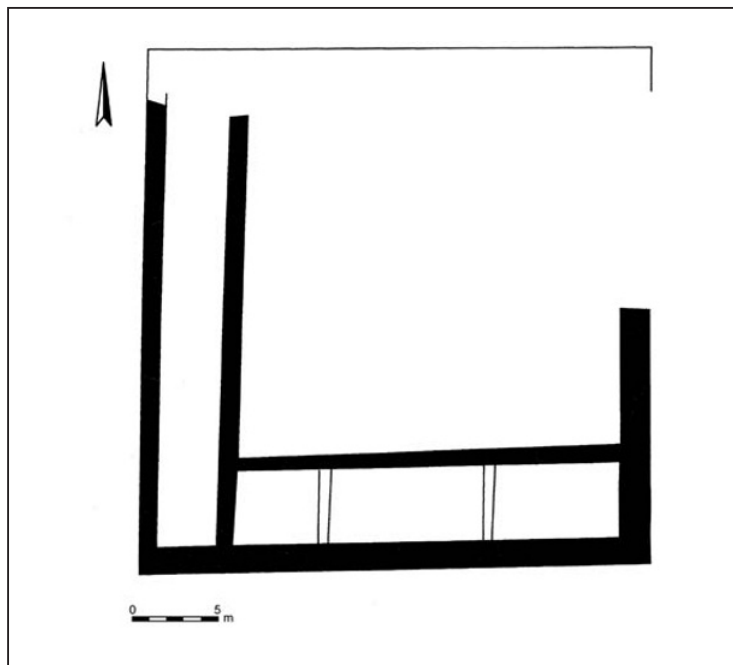
The size of the original courtyard was 30×30 m. The entrance to the courtyard was from the east. At a distance of 5 m from the inside of the courtyard walls there are parallel walls, probably the remains of roofed areas. In two places, inner dividing walls are preserved. The construction

of all the walls is of field stones. About 50 m west of the farmhouse is a round structure about 4 m in diameter.

**Pottery:** Persian – 95%; Byzantine – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Bibliography:** Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 78.



98. Plan of the structure at Wa'aret et-Tin. This is a building-courtyard, which may have been a farmhouse from the Persian period, 1998.

Site 74: 17-20/58/2

## El-Mahluf

Israel grid: 1753 2083

UTM grid: 7130 5949

Elevation: 256 m a.s.l., 55 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small; enclosure and structure

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

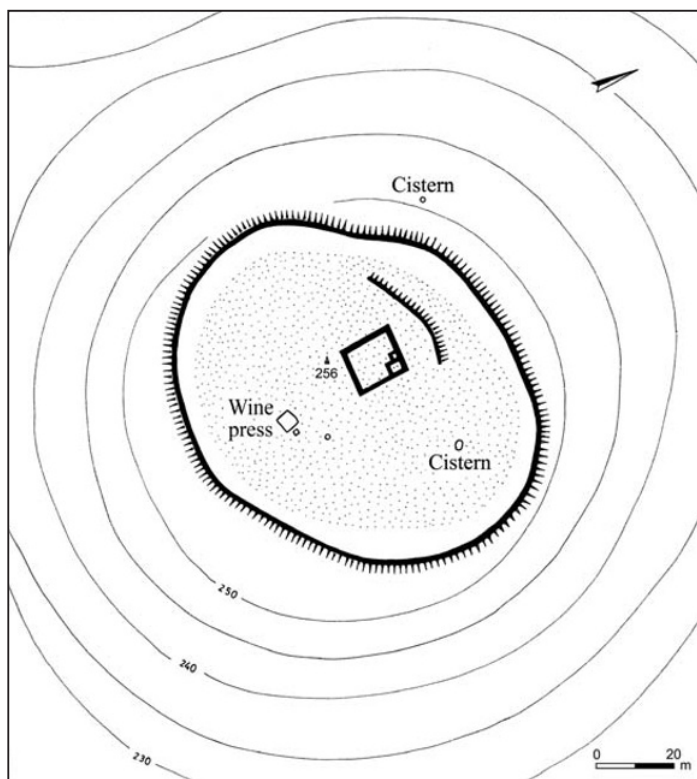
Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Ḥanuni (no. 157),  
1.7 km distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 1.5 km  
distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: June 1979 - 42 sherds;  
Sept. 1997 – plan.



99. Plan of the Middle Bronze Age site at el-Mahluf. The site was surrounded by a ramp and only one structure was found in it, drawn 1998.

A site on a high isolated hilltop, part of the range linking the Dothan Valley with the Jenin region. The site is 1.5 km northeast of Burqin, and the same distance south-east of Kafr Dan. Ginnat, a new settlement, is 700 m north-east of the site, whose upper part is cultivated today, while its relatively steep slopes have pine trees growing on them. There is a good view from here of the Jezreel Valley and Wadi Burqin.

The upper part of the hilltop is surrounded by a stone wall 1–2 m high, apparently belonging to the complex, and perhaps comprising an ancient fortification. The enclosure is elliptical, with a diameter of about 100 m. Inside the wall, on the upper part of the hilltop, is a well-preserved square structure, 15×15 m, built of well-arranged field stones. Its 2 m-wide entrance is on its eastern side. In the north-west corner of the structure is a square room, 3×3 m, built in the same manner as the main structure. South of this structure is a large rock-cut winepress. Two cisterns and other quarried places were found around the site. These are apparently later in date than the original construction of the site.

This is one of many Middle Bronze Age II sites, some of them fortified, in the area.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze IIb – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Bibliography:** Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 79; Salem 2006: site 180.



Site 75: 16-20/77/1

## **Khirbet eṭ-Turm**

Israel grid: 1678 2073

UTM grid: 7055 5936

Elevation: 400 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: tell

Area: about 20 dunams (2 ha)

Topography: hilltop on hilly plateau

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 25

Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146),  
2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 1 km  
distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Dec. 1978; 69 sherds



100. The main building at Khirbet eṭ-Turm, facing north-east, 1978. Photo: A. Zertal.

A large ruin on a tell rising slightly above the mountainous plain, about 2 km north-east of Ya'bad. From the tell a small ravine descends to the north-east towards the village of 'Arraqah. Next to it is a new small settlement bearing the same name.

In the centre of the tell is a large, two-storey structure which today serves as a dwelling. Its three lowest stone layers include many especially large building stones, on the average 40×50×100 cm. It can be surmised that this formerly served as a fortified structure during the Middle Ages or the Ottoman period.

On all four sides of the structure are many ancient ruins: terraces in which building stones are found, walls made of large stones, agricultural installations of all types (oil presses, wine vats, etc.). Upper and lower crushing stones for olives and well lids were also found. Many of these stones are now concentrated to the east of the main house. On the slopes of the tell many building remains and about ten caves, now used as store-rooms and pens for flocks of animals, were found.

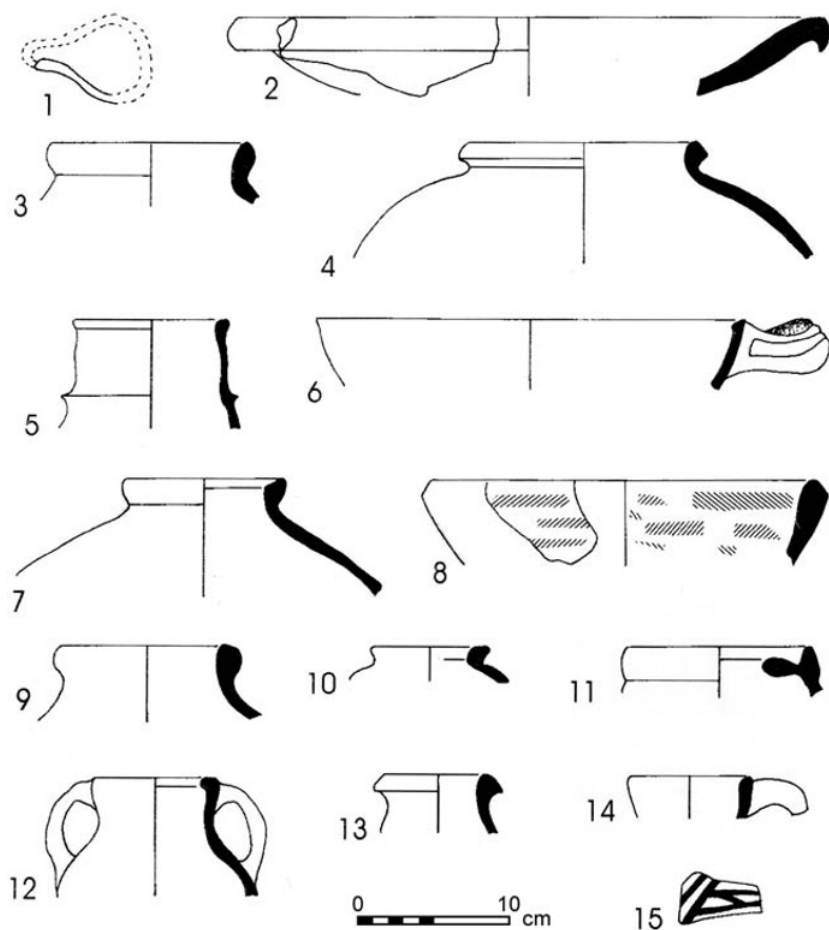
At the site there was a large settlement presumably founded in the Persian period, which developed into a tell, possibly fortified, in the Hellenistic and Roman periods. The foundations of the central structure may have been laid during the Roman period.

The British Survey mentions "traces of ruins" (Conder and Kitchener

1882: 63). According to Grossman (1977: 400) Khirbet eṭ-Ṭurm was a subsidiary settlement of Ya'bad and was founded in the 19<sup>th</sup> century. The ceramic find indicates a far longer continuity of settlement.

**Pottery:** Iron – 5%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 25%; Late Roman – 25%; Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



101. Pottery from Khirbet eṭ-Ṭurm: 1. Pinched jug rim, lt, IA II; 2. Bowl, lt, Pers; 3. Jug, lt, Pers; 4. Jar, lt, Pers; 5. Jar, gr-blk, Byz; 6. 'Frying pan', brn, Byz; 7. Jar, lt, Hel; 8. Bowl, brn on lt, MA; 9. Jar, gr, Pers; 10. Juglet, brn, Byz; 11. HM, gr, Pers; 12. Pilgrim flask, lt brn, IA II; 13. Juglet, lt, Hel; 14. Jug, brn, LR, 15. Dec, brn on lt, Mam (MA).

Site 76: 17-20/07/2

## El-Khariq

Israel grid: 1704 2074

UTM grid: 7082 5937

Elevation: 345 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: ridge on high slope

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Hashmiyeh  
(no. 26), 300 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km  
distant

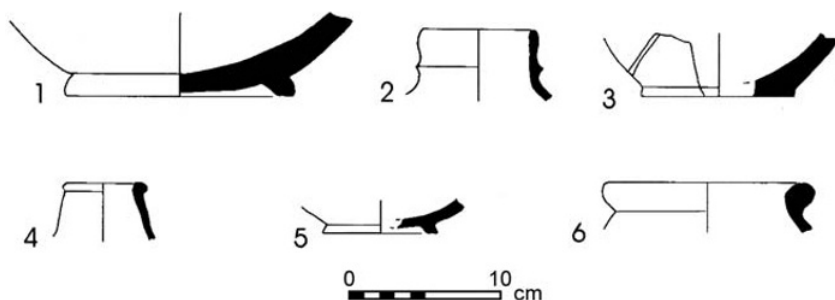
Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Nov. 1982; 39 sherds

A small site on a slope in the high northern part of esh-Shibl Range, which borders the Dothan Valley in the north. It is 1 km south-west of el-Hashmiyeh, and is linked to the village by an unpaved road.

This site, like neighbouring Joret el-Kharrubeh, is on the high Shibl-'Asi Range. The main structure here is situated on the surface of two wide terraces, and is visible as a wide elevated ramp. The sides of the ramp are about 40 m long, and its height is about 1 m above the surface. On and near the ramp a few remains of walls are visible. Apparently this was a settlement with a central structure or enclosure. In the area of the ramp, on terraces and on the slope, was a small sherd scatter. A modern house now stands there.

**Pottery:** Iron II – 5%; Persian – 45%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 40%.  
**Previous surveys:** None.



102. Pottery from el-Khariq: 1.Jar base, dk gr, Pers; 2.Jar, lt, Hel; 3.Jug base, gr, Pers; 4.Juglet, brn, ER; 5.Bowl base, lt, Hel; 6.Jar, yel, Pers.

Site 77: 17-20/07/1

## Joret el-Kharrubeh

Israel grid: 1706 2077

UTM grid: 7080 5939

Elevation: 345 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1.7 dunams (1700 sq. m)

Topography: slope on high range

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir Hashmiyeh  
(no. 26), 500 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Nov. 1982; 39 sherds

A site on a slope to the west of the village of el-Hashmiyeh, in the heights of the range between the Dothan Valley and the low hilly area at the western edge of the Jezreel Valley. There is a good view of the Jezreel Valley.

The site is located on wide man-made steps supported by terraces on the slope. On the steps a modern house has been built, with more houses nearby.

No ancient building remains were explored. Their stones were found in



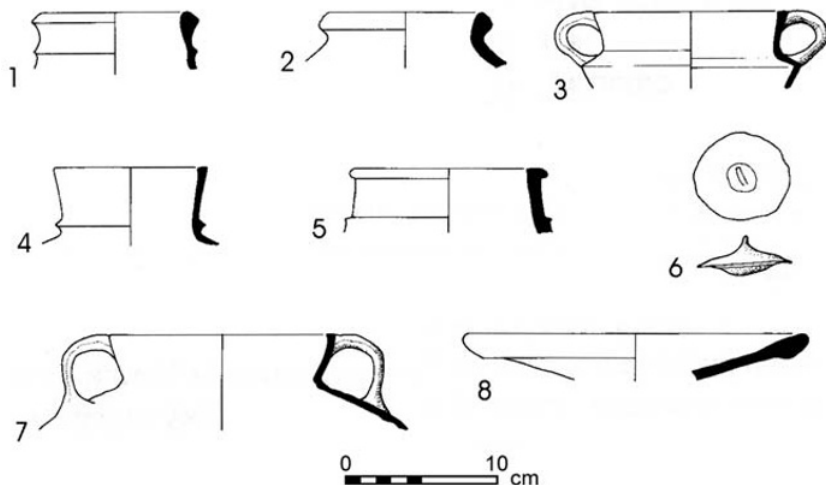
103. The village of el-Hashmiyeh (in the centre), Sheikh esh-Shibl (the range behind it) and Joret el-Kharrubeh (to the right of the village); bird's eye view, facing south. In the background is the Dothan Valley, 1998. Photo: M. Weinberg.



modern fences, terraces and new constructions. On the steps and in the cultivated areas was a sherd scatter, indicating the ancient settlement.

**Pottery:** Iron II – 10%; Persian – 40%; Hellenistic – 5%; Early Roman – 40%; Modern – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



104. Pottery from Joret el-Kharrubeh: 1.Jar, reddish-gr, IA II; 2.Jar, lt, Pers; 3.CP, brn, ER; 4-5.Jars, lt, ER; 6.Lid, lt, Hel (?); 7.CP, brn, Rom; 8.Bowl, lt, Pers.



105. Joret el-Kharrubeh (where the house is), looking south, 1982.

Site 78: 17-20/17/2

# El-Hashmiyeh (el-Bard) (on British Survey map – el Barid)

Israel grid: 1710 2078

UTM grid: 7087 5942

Elevation: 345 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not as historic site

Site type: Arab village on tell

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: high ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 18

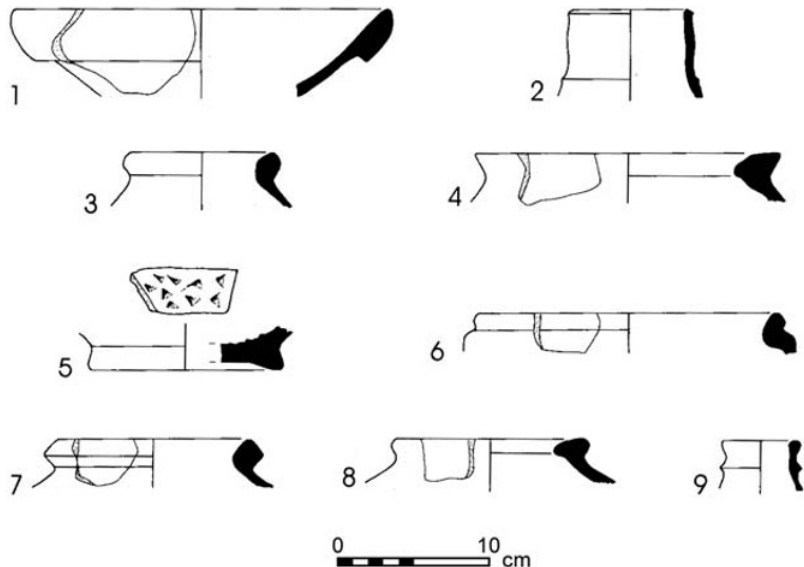
Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23), 800 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Nov. 1982; 49 sherds

A small Arab village on a tell in the middle of a ridge that descends northward from the esh-Shibl Range to the Ta'anach Hills. To the east and west, steep slopes descend from the village. There is a good view of the Jezreel Valley.



106. Pottery from el-Hashmiyeh: 1. Bowl, yel, Pers; 2. Jar, lt, ER; 3. Jar, gr, Pers.; 4. Jar, lt, MB II; 5. Wedge-shaped dec bowl, brn-gr, IA III; 6. CP, brn, IA II; 7. Jar, lt, Pers; 8. Jar, lt, MB II; 9. Jug, brn, LR.

The area of the condensed ancient core is 3-4 dunams (3000-4000 sq. m). The homes are crowded on top of a low tell; building remains and carved stones are seen in the walls of houses. To the east and west of the ancient core there are several new houses. The paved road from Kafr Qud approaches the village from the east, crosses it, and descends to 'Arraqah.

Guérin (1969b: 224) describes: "We passed through several rocky hills... at six o'clock we reached el-Bard, now a very small village" [translated from French, A.Z.].

The village does not appear in the 1596 census. The British Survey describes the place as "a small hamlet on the hillside, with a well to the west" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46). In 1931 there were 190 residents and 41 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 432). Grossman (1986: 345) relates that it was founded by the family of Abd el-Hadi 200 years ago. During his visit Porath (1968: no. 16) found "at the eastern entrance to the village a stone lintel broken in two, bearing a Greek inscription. It was taken from a burial cave the entrance of which was built of ashlar with fine cutting of its edges. On either side of the inscription was a carved bird (a dove). The one on the right was worn down and the head of the one on the left was broken, except for its beak". In our visit in 1982 we did not find it.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze IIb – 10%; Iron II – 20%; Iron III – 5%; Persian – 40%; Hellenistic – 5%; Roman – 10%; Ottoman-Modern – 10%.

**Previous surveys:** Porath 1968: no. 16.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 97; Salem 2006: sites 97, 335.

Site 79: 17-20/17/1

## El-Kharaiyyeq

Israel grid: 1719 2079

UTM grid: 7096 5943

Elevation: 405 m a.s.l., 105 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortified

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 3

Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23),  
500 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 1 km  
distant

Visibility: 9

Date of visit: June 1979; Nov. 1998;  
54 sherds

A large, fortified site on the summit of el-Kharaiyyeq, the eastern part of the el-'Asi Range, north of the Dothan Valley. West of it is a saddle on which the road runs from Kafr Qud to el-Hashmiyeh (which is 1 km west of this site). There is a good view from here of the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys.

The sausage-shaped site was surrounded by a well-built stone wall about 2 m thick. The wall has been well preserved along the southern slope of the ridge, while its other sections are partially visible. In the western and eastern parts of the wall two round towers are preserved: they are about



107. The site of el-Kharaiyyeq, looking west. The line of the wall can be seen on the hilltop, 1998.

5×5 m and well built of cut field stones.

Within the wall, and over all the surface of the site, are remains of structures and walls *in situ*. The decay, clearing of stones, and cultivation make it difficult to distinguish building plans, but apparently this was a densely populated place. To the west, next to the tower, are the possible remains of a fortified gateway.

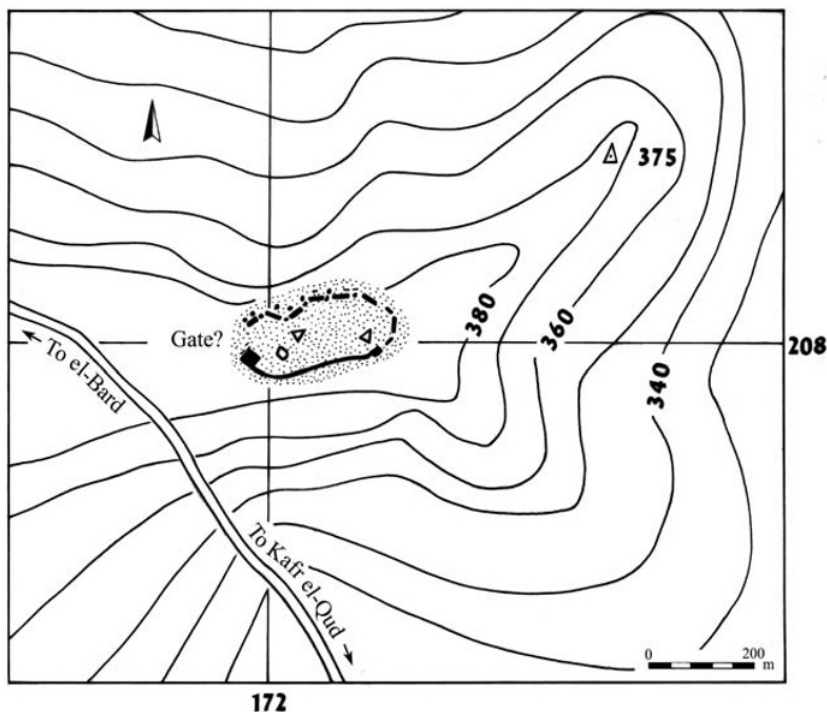
At el-Kharaiyyeq are the remains of a fortified settlement with structures dating to the Persian period. The place is situated on a particularly prominent spot, and some historical significance can possibly be attributed to it.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze II – 2%; Persian – 98%.

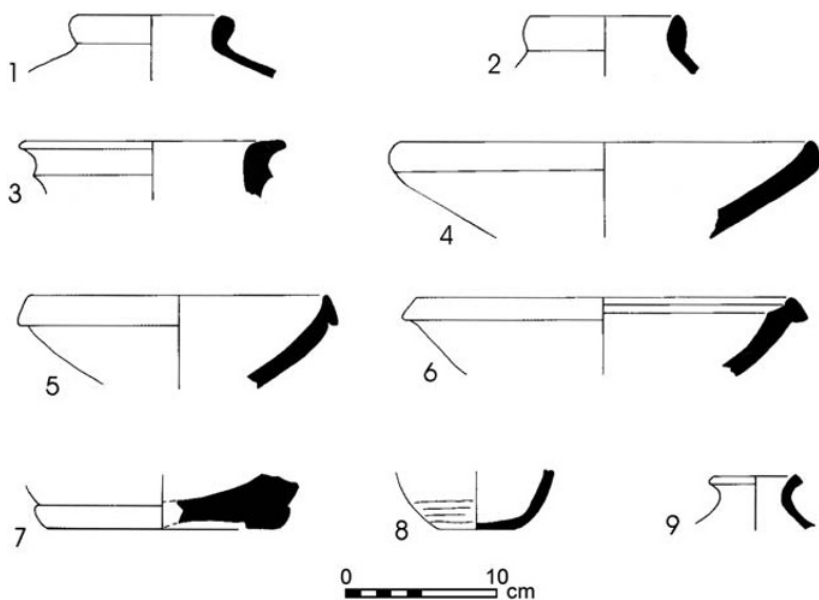
**Identification:** The location and fortification, correlated with the geographical details of the Book of Judith, offer a possible identification as Betuliyah, one of the most important cities in that book; see Chapter 2.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Bibliography:** Salem 2006: site 92.



108. Plan of the fortified site at el-Kharaiyyeq, 1979.



109. Pottery from el-Kharaiyyeq, all Pers except item 3: 1-2.Jars, yel; 3.Jar, lt, MB II;  
4-6.Bowls, gr and yel; 7.Jar base, gr; 8.Jar base, yel; 9.Jug, gr.

Site 80: 17-20/87/1

## Tel Jenin, Jenin

Israel grid: 1783 2074

UTM grid: 7161 5940

Elevation: 230 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as ancient city

Site type: tell in centre of modern city

Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)

Topography: valley fringes

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: alluvial

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 40 (in ancient core)

Water source: 'Ein Sharifeh (no. 31), 800 m distant

Road: Jatt-Jenin (A4), at site

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: 1978

A medium-sized city with a tell at the southern side of the Jezreel Valley, in the narrow entrance to the Bel'ameh Pass and the Dothan Valley. The place is a junction from which roads branch out to Burkin (A4), Samaria (B4), Megiddo (A2), and 'Afula.

**Modern visits and excavations:** At the time of our visit there was almost no trace left of the tell, and thus we will rely on the descriptions of Porath (1968: site 18) Tzori (1977: site 70), and Salem (2006).

The former states: "the northern part of the tell was dug up by earthmoving contractors and a bus station was built there. In the cross-section of the tell, which is about 6 m high, walls, floors and dwelling levels can be seen. In the eastern part... a fallen brick wall could be discerned, some of whose bricks had been burnt by the destruction blaze. At the top of the tell were Byzantine structures, in a process of destruction as a result of the stones looting. The stone foundations of these structures penetrated into the Canaanite-Israelite level...domestic levels from the Middle Canaanite Period onward could be seen. At the foot of the tell to the north is a group of springs" (Porath 1968: 6).

Tzori (1977: 46), one of the last to visit the place when the tell was still in existence, writes: "The ancient site of Jenin was found in the area of a car garage between the main street and Jam'a Street. According to the residents, it was a tall site but was "lowered" at the beginning of the 1960's to 6 m above the road level. The original dimensions of the tell certainly would have reached 150×150 m, but little of it can be seen today due to construction and landscaping on top of it. Cross sections can be seen especially in the west and south, e.g., a 90 m cross section facing north. Settlement layers, walls, floors and burnt layers can be discerned within it. Outstanding among the vessels

collected there was an Iron Age carinated krater”.

In 1977 Glock conducted a small, emergency excavation there and discovered various settlement strata. In the east of the tell an area of 13×4 m was excavated, and it transpired that the site was first settled during Early Bronze Age I. An apsidal structure was found with two stages of construction. After a long gap, settlement was renewed at the end of the Late Bronze Age (13<sup>th</sup>–12<sup>th</sup> centuries BCE). Dwelling rooms and installations (cisterns and stone circles) were found. Pottery included Early Philistine sherds alongside a bronze axe, a gold earring, and a glass bottle (*Hadashot Arkheologiyot* 65–66).

In 1978, a barrel-vault grave was excavated. It contained nine niches, which were blocked by stone slabs. The finds included oil lamps, small jars and glass vessels from the 2<sup>nd</sup> century CE. (*Hadashot Arkheologiyot* 67–68).

**History:** The tell and the city of Jenin have a long history. In the el-Amarna letters it is mentioned as the Land of Gin-na. The Roman name was Ginae. Josephus Flavius described a village in the ‘Great Plain’, on the border of



110. A street in Jenin in the 1920s (Preiss and Rohrbach 1925: 170).



the Galilee and Samaria (War III: iii, 4). Both Theodoricus and Burchardt of Zion mention it in 1156 as “the border between the Galilee and Samaria”. In the Middle Ages it was called by various names: Le Gerin, Major Gallina, Geninum Magnum, Geninum (Beyer 1940: 185, 194).

According to the Arab geographers it was a ‘lovely city’ (Yaquṭ II: 180–181), known for the tomb of Yihia el-Kalbi. During the wars against the Crusaders, Salāḥ ed-Din captured it several times. In 1184 he went out of Kerak to Nablus in order to raid the Frankish city. Threatened by the Crusader army, he retreated toward Jenin and burned it. This was the last encounter before the Battle of Hittin in 1187. After the battle, the armies of Salāḥ ed-Din passed through Jenin on their way to Sebastia and Nablus. El-Malek el Nasr Yusuf from Aleppo granted half of it to Baibars, together with half of Nablus and 120 horsemen. In the armistice between Qalaun and the Franks in May 1283 Jenin is especially mentioned. Under Mamluk rule, Jenin became the capital city of one of the 11 (later, 12) districts in the geographical region (*Amal*) of Safed. ‘Assaf Ibn Trabay, of a tribe by this name that had settled in the Jenin area, took part in the conquest of the land from the Mamluks in 1516 and received responsibility for the King’s road from Quneitrah to Nablus (Yakutieli 1971: 210).

In 1564 a royal proclamation (*firman*) was given to construct a fortress at Jenin in these words:

“Order to the Beglerbeg of Damascus:

‘You have sent a letter and have reported that Hassan, Beg of Nablus, and Kemal, Beg of Lajjun, have sent [you] a letter. [According to it,] the village named Jenin in the sanjak of Lajjun is [situated] on the road to Jerusalem and Egypt, on the border of the sanjak of Nablus, and in the middle of the country close to the sanjak of ‘Ajlun. If the stone caravanserai which is [located] within it [the village] were repaired, if forty mounted musketeers and ten fortress-soldiers (*hisar eri*) were [stationed] and if those who are Begs of Lajjun took up their residence there, the above-mentioned sanjaks would greatly prosper and the road to Egypt and Jerusalem would become safe and secure. It would be sufficient to grant each mounted musketeer a timar of 2,000 aspers [a year] and each fortress-soldier a timar of 1,400 aspers [a year] from the surplus (*ifraz*) of the *hass*-fiefs of the sanjak over and above what is given to him (the Sanjak-Beg of Lajjun).

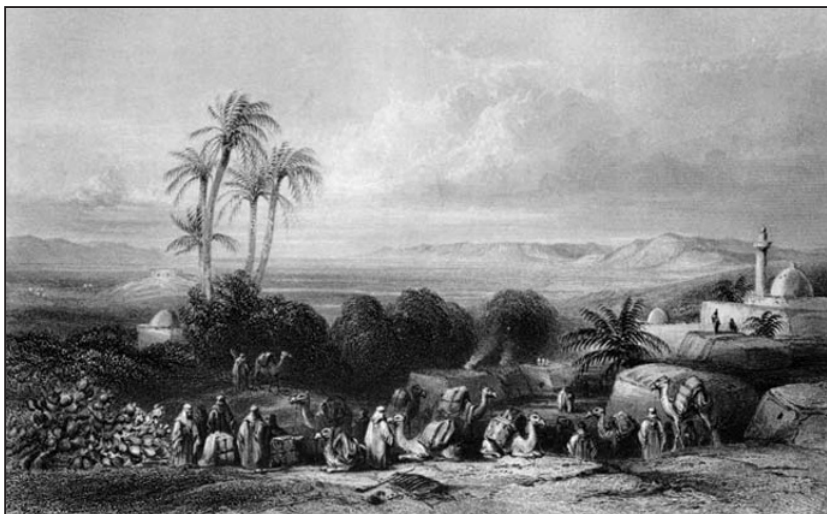
I have therefore ordered that the caravanserai mentioned in the report become a fortress and forty mounted musketeers and ten fortress-soldiers (*hisar eri*) be enlisted with the above-mentioned amount of timars from the said surplus.

'I have commanded when [this firman] arrives the said caravanserai be repaired. When it has become a fortress you shall, as you have proposed, confer, from the above-mentioned surplus, timars of 2,000 aspers each on forty mounted musketeers and timars of 1,400 aspers each on ten guards (*mustahfiz*) [to be enlisted] from among the *kul ogullari* and *kul karindasi* and [others] who deserve a livelihood (*dirlik*). You shall send [in] their certificates (*tezkiye*) so that my imperial diplomas (*berat*) may be issued. 'Thus shall you know'" (Heyd 1960: document 56, pp. 104-105).

Due to its location on the route from Cairo to Damascus, Jenin served as an important mail station. It is mentioned in several places as a station between Fahmeh and Hittin. In the list of stations for conveying snow from Lebanon ('express mail') Jenin is mentioned between Irbid and Qequn. The city was also a stage station for horses carrying mail ('pony express') and mail pigeons (Volney 1798/9: 33, 38; Stephan 1938: 86-87, note 5).

In 1596 Jenin was a village in the Jenin *Nahiyeh*. It paid 2000 *aqia* in taxes, 1400 of it for wheat, 160 for barley, 140 for summer crops, 150 for miscellaneous, and 150 for goats and honey. No tax was paid for olives or olive presses; thus it appears that the lands belonging to Jenin's residents were all in the valley (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 160).

The Turkish traveller, Evliya Tshelebi visited the place in 1648-50, and this is his description of the fortress of Jenin: "It was built in the year [ ] by the sultan [ ] of Egypt. Later on it was enlarged under the Ottomans, so that it became a strong fortress. It belongs to the private Imperial *Waqfs* in Jabal 'Ajlun, which have been set down in writing at an early date (*maqtu-i qalem ve mefruz el-qidam*). The Governor is its *mutevelli*. A warden with a garrison of two hundred soldiers lives in it. It is a small, yet strong, rectangular flourishing fortress, situated on a raised terrace, measuring a thousand paces in circumference. From within it is fully occupied with guest-chambers. In its very centre rises a lovely mosque with a well proportioned minaret covered with lead roof. It is a delightful mosque. In its inner court is a huge water-basin ten by ten [paces]. Out of the revenue of the building the travellers receive freely a loaf of bread and a bowl of soup [for each person] as well as a tallow candle light to each hearth [*ujaq*]. Should however, a distinguished person arrive, then the traditional table [*simat-i Muhammadi*] would be set, and he would be treated for three days as a guest. As a rule, a nosebag of barley and fodder is given for every horse. It is a well-endowed *waqf*. On both sides of the arches of the high road are one hundred masonry-built shops, with iron gates at both ends. South of the suburb of the fortress a flourishing townlet of one hundred houses stretches over an ascending slope. It has a



111. Jenin, etching from *The Biblical Keepsake* by E. Finden (London, 1835).

mosque and a public bath. Near the caravanserai seven date palms rise to a considerable height, similar to those found in the oases of Egypt. Amidst them, under a white dome, is the shrine of Sheikh 'Izz-ed-din bin esh Sheikh Muhammed er Rifa'i. Beside him the ancestors of the Terabi Oghlu [chieftains?] are buried within." (Stephan 1938: 86-87).

In 1694 the *Mutesellim* (governor) of Jenin, Hussein Beck, and the *Mutesellim* of Nablus, Aly Aga en-Nimr, applied to the governor of Damascus in regard to the Arab Turkoman Bedouin tribes. They were living on the fringes of the Jezreel Valley, and were in the habit of raiding the villages in the region. In response to the application the Turks were exiled toward Haifa and Tiberias (Yekutieli 1971: 214).

In 1774 the city was involved in the struggles between Dahar el-Omar and the Ottoman government. Internal struggles led to the creation of a coalition of Dahar and the leaders of Mount Nablus against the forces of the government in Damascus, Egypt and the army of Emir Shihabi. In order to withstand the attack, fortifications were built in many places, among them Jenin (Yekutieli 1971: 215).

In 1845 Rabbi Yehosef Schwarz wrote about the city, "South of Zer'in inclined to the west about an hour and a half is the village of Jenin where the Jezreel Valley begins (Merj Ibn 'Amir) and close to the village is a small river called 'Ain Jenin (En Ganim [Spring of Gardens]). See the explanation of rivers under the name Ginay Nahra. In Chronicles in the Levite cites it is

called Anem. It is named in the names of the Levite cities. And the remark is added: 'It is not a village but a city and the place where the administrator sits.' (Schwarz 1900: 203).

Robinson reached Jenin on June 15, 1852, describing it as follows: "This place is situated in the mouth of the same Wady, as it enters the great plain of Esdraelon, having gentle hills on either side. The town lies in the midst of gardens of fruit trees, which are surrounded by hedges of the prickly pear; here too are seen a few scattered palm trees. The houses are of stone tolerably well built; the place may contain perhaps two thousand inhabitants; among whom are only three or four families of Greek Christians. The most remarkable thing here is the fine flowing public fountain, rising in the hills back of the town, and brought down so as to issue in a noble stream in the midst of the place. The fountain is built up with plain but good mason work. It has a reservoir of stone, in which the people may dip their jars; and also a long stone trough for the herds and flocks. The water flows off north-westwards towards the Mediterranean. This fountain had not long been built; and is a good specimen of the public spirit of Husein 'Abu el-Hady, Late Mudir of 'Akka, whose authority extended over all the southern provinces of Syria. Husein was the head of a powerful family; was very rich; and employed some two or three hundred yoke of oxen in cultivating the plain of Esdraelon. He was now dead, and one of his brothers had succeeded to the same office. One of his sons was at this time governor of Nabulus. Another was also governor of Jenin, which is the chief place of the district embracing the great plain, and is subordinate to Nabulus, in the same manner as Hebron is to Jerusalem. He too cultivates large tracts of land upon the plain in the vicinity of Jenin." (Robinson 1970 II: 315).

De Saulcy reached the city on Dec. 26, 1863 and wrote: "At 5:30 we reached Jenin, on the plain by which the city is approached from the west. Our baggage had already arrived and our tents were set up. Opposite us were three other tents in which were several Englishwomen. Two of them were young and pretty, and they were accompanied by a young priest. No contact was made between us and them, and the night passed in total silence and with much dampness, which came from both above and below... Along the valley on which the city is located, I noticed a large cemetery with many openings of graves hewn in rock, which must be closely examined. At the bottom of the valley are two well-built dams, one of them breached. These are clearly not Turkish buildings. On the left side of the valley I noticed a built arch that enters the mountain. It is clear that these monuments must be investigated with much more time and patience" (de Saulcy 1865, II: 254-255).

During Guérin's visit in 1870 there were 2000 inhabitants, almost all of them Moslems, except for a few Greek Orthodox and a Catholic family. In his words: "the city sits on a moderate slope of a hill... there are two mosques in the city... one of them is relatively large; on it is a tower soars, crowned by a hilltop... the other mosque is much smaller, and stands next to an abundant spring whose water flows through the city in a canal that was renovated roughly 40 years ago... the remains of a stable building that was built of large stones is, according to the residents, the ruin of a fortress (*Qal'ah*)" (Guérin 1969a: 327–332; translated from French, A.Z.).

Conder and Kitchener (1882: 44–45) wrote of Jenin: "Jenin – The capital of the district, the seat of a Kaimakam, is a town of about 3,000 inhabitants, with a small bazaar. The houses are well built of stone. There are two families of Roman Catholics; the remainder are Moslems. A spring rises east of the town and is conducted to a large masonry reservoir, near the west side, of good squared stonework, with a long stone trough. This reservoir was built by 'Abd el Hady, Mudir of Acre, in the first half of the century. Towards the north of the town is the little mosque of 'Ezz ed-Din, with a good sized hilltop and a minaret. This may perhaps occupy the site of the Christian church mentioned in 1555 A.D. (...). Jenin is remarkable for its fine gardens north of the town. They are walled with cactus, and contain palms, oranges, tamarisks, and vegetables. Two small mills, now ruined, communicated with the fountain by an aqueduct on low arches. The threshing-floor is to the west, where there are also olives..."

None of the visitors to the place, until the 20<sup>th</sup> century, mention the ancient tell.

Salem (2006) has published a doctorate dissertation dealing with the settlement layout around Tell Jenin during the Early Bronze Age. In the dissertation he summed up the results of the archaeological excavations conducted in the tell (Salem 2006: 71–88). Henceforth are the main strata:

Stratum I: This is a geological layer preceding the habitation of the tell.

Stratum II, the Pre-Pottery Neolithic: A plaster floor and a wall were exposed. The flint find included arrowheads and blades. Several small installations were also found. This layer was covered by alluvium probably brought by a flood occurring in the wadi. Sherds from the Pottery Neolithic and early Chalcolithic were found in the fillings of later periods, but living layers from those periods have not yet been identified.

Stratum III, Late Chalcolithic and Early Bronze Age Ia: A massive foundation, built over the wadi bank, aimed at raising the living level at the site to prevent its flooding. It was built of pebbles and earth on the alluvium

layer covering the one below it. Sherds from the Early Bronze Age I, Chalcolithic and Pottery Neolithic periods found in the alluvium layer testify to some sort of human activity taking place at the site during a certain time between Strata II and III. An apsidal structure, courtyard and two pits were excavated.

Stratum IV, Early Bronze Age Ib: Remains of an apsidal house with a plastered floor and a partially paved courtyard next to it were revealed.

Stratum V, Late Bronze Age (13<sup>th</sup>–12<sup>th</sup> centuries BCE): On the southern side of the tell a massive supporting wall was built. The space between this wall and the collapses of the earlier layers was filled with earth. On the northern side of the tell were unearthened remains of a house with a stone threshold and paved courtyard. In the brick collapse covering the structure was found diagnostic pottery including imported Cypriot vessels.

Strata VI–VII, Byzantine: A massive wall was unearthened at the southern part of the tell. A structure with a plaster floor, a paved courtyard, and an oven was excavated. On the south-western side of the tell, probably used mainly as a residential quarter, a stone foundation was constructed, on which were built at least two private houses with a common courtyard with installations, ovens, and pits.

Stratum VIII, 7<sup>th</sup> century CE: In this layer the cultural continuity from the previous one is significant. A wall and a plastered floor abutting it were excavated.

Stratum IX, Ottoman: remains of plastered floors and walls.

Stratum X, Modern times: remains of a street, a drainage system and dug pits.

**Pottery** (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Pottery Neolithic; Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I–II; Middle Bronze II; Late Bronze; Iron I; Iron II; Persian; Hellenistic; Early Roman; Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Ottoman.

**Identification:** The tell has been identified as being in the region of the Land of Gina of Amarna (letter no. 250). In addition the cities of 'En Ganim and Bet Haggan (Josh 19:21; 21:29), Ginay of the Book of Judith (3:11) and of Josephus (Ant. XX [vi,1]; War III [iii, 4]) were all identified here. It was called Le Grand Gerin in the Crusader period and others; see Chapter 2.

**Previous surveys:** Porath 1968: no. 18; Tzori 1977: site 70.

**Additional Bibliography:** Avi-Yohah 1963: 125; Tzori 1972; Moran 1987: 475–477; Dauphin 1998, III: site 99; Goren et al. 2004: 350; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 81.

Site 81: 16-20/76/1

## Wadi 'Asl (A)

Israel grid: 1677 2065

UTM grid: 7055 5928

Elevation: 310 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structures

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir ej-Jamal (no. 32),  
2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 700 m  
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Dec. 1978; 22 sherds

Structures on a rocky slope descending to Wadi 'Askary, in the hilly area east of Ya'bad and north of the Dothan Valley.

On the site are two large rectangular structures, built of cut stones, close together on the slope. They are both about 5×6 m and about 2.5 m high. The stones of the bottom layer are about 30×40×100 cm each, while the stones of the upper layers are smaller. The bottom layers, found *in situ*, were laid by the header method. The rest of the stones are scattered about.

Near the structures are quarried places and scattered sherds. The area around the site is entirely cultivated and contains piles of cleared stones and terraces.

**Pottery:** Byzantine – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

Site 82: 16-20/86/1

## Khirbet Ras ed-Dibl

|                                      |                                                        |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1688 2068               | Soil quality: 6                                        |
| UTM grid: 7066 5931                  | Cultivation: none                                      |
| Elevation: 380 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a. | Cisterns: 1                                            |
| Name type: ancient, but not on map   | Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146),<br>1.2 km distant |
| Site type: farm                      | Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km<br>distant              |
| Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)          | Visibility: 7                                          |
| Topography: hilltop and ridge        | Date of visit: Dec. 1978; 21 sherds                    |
| Rock type: Judah group               |                                                        |
| Soil type: rendzina and brown forest |                                                        |

Remains of a farm on a high chalky hilltop north of the village of Kufeirat, on the upper, western part of the range bordering the Dothan Valley in the north. Near the site is a built path from Kufeirat to Khirbet eṭ-Ṭurm. From the site is a good view of the Dothan Valley and the 'Arraqah region.

This is a well-preserved farm with its buildings and installations. The structures include a central building, today covered by cleared stones, and other structures around it. The central building is rectangular, about 20 m long, with an entrance on the north and a door lintel *in situ*. About 10 m north of it are the remains of a small square stone structure, and next to it is a hewn cistern whose ceiling has collapsed. Apparently there were more buildings on the site, whose remains can be seen here and there. There are also installations, a wine vat and other quarried places scattered around the buildings.

**Pottery:** Byzantine – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** Zertal 1984: no. 1.



Site 83: 16-20/75/1

## Wadi 'Askar

|                                      |                                      |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1679 2058               | Cultivation: olives                  |
| UTM grid: 7058 5922                  | Cisterns: 1                          |
| Elevation: 315 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a. | Water source: Bir ej-Jamal (no. 32), |
| Name type: ancient, but not on map   | 2 km distant                         |
| Site type: farm                      | Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 1.5 km     |
| Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)          | distant                              |
| Topography: hilltop                  | Visibility: 3                        |
| Rock type: Mount Scopus group        | Date of visit: Dec. 1978, Oct. 1997; |
| Soil type: rendzina                  | 37 sherds                            |
| Soil quality: 5                      |                                      |

Remains of an agricultural farm on a low hilltop in the hilly region south-east of Tell Masalleh and 1.5 km east of Ya'bad.

On the hilltop, located in an inner valley, are remains of a few structures covered with cleared stones. Courtyards, surrounded by low walls and with piles of cleared stones in them, abut the structures. The structures are raised on a built level created by thick terrace walls on the edge of the slope.

The site appears to be a typical farm of the Persian period. In a return visit in Oct. 1997 the ancient site was found to have been entirely destroyed, and olive trees had been planted in its place. Sherds could still be found in the orchard.

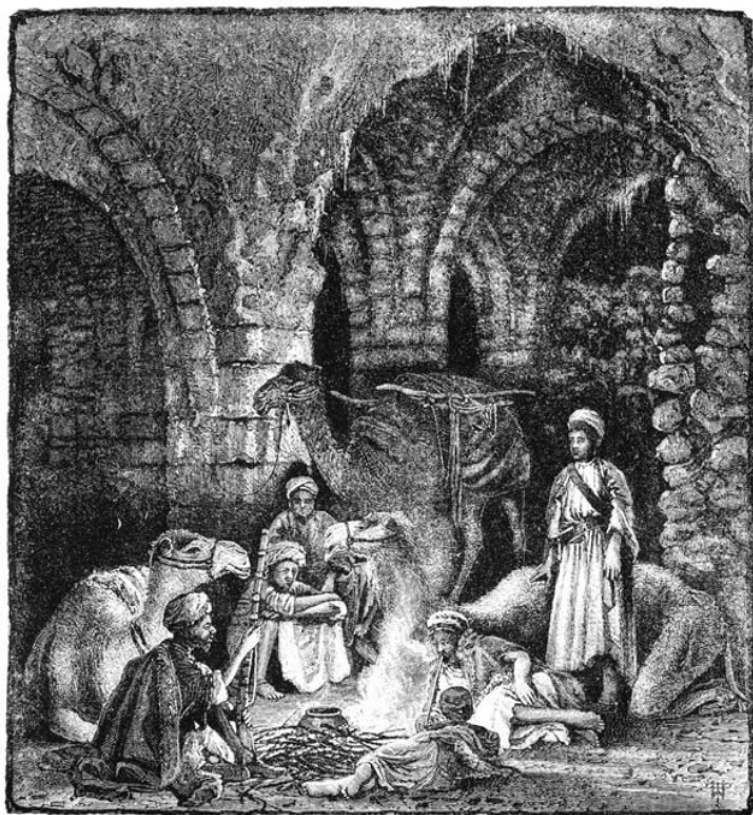
**Pottery:** Persian – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** Zertal 1984: no. 8.

CHAPTER FIVE

HILLS OF YA'BAD

LANDSCAPE UNIT 24



112. Overnight stay in a khan, etching from Charles Wilson's *Picturesque Palestine* (London, 1880).



Site 84: 16-20/29/1

## Wadi Yaḥmur

Israel grid: 1625 2099

UTM grid: 7001 5961

Elevation: 350 m a.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name type: not on map

Site type: structure and sherd  
scatter

Area: about 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: ravine edges

Rock type: alluvium

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Sahaleh (no. 13),  
1.2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 1 km  
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Nov. 1997; 39 sherds

A large structure on the bank of Wadi Yaḥmur, opposite the Umm Riḥan forest reserve, and just south of the Qatzir-Shaqed asphalt road.

The dimensions of the structure are 10×12 m, and it is made of exceptionally large hewn stones, placed according to the header-and-stretcher method. At the high south-western corner it is preserved to about 3 m



113. The southern structure at Wadi Yaḥmur, looking south-east. 1998. Photo: M. Weinberg.

height. The masonry is of high quality and there is no inner division into rooms.

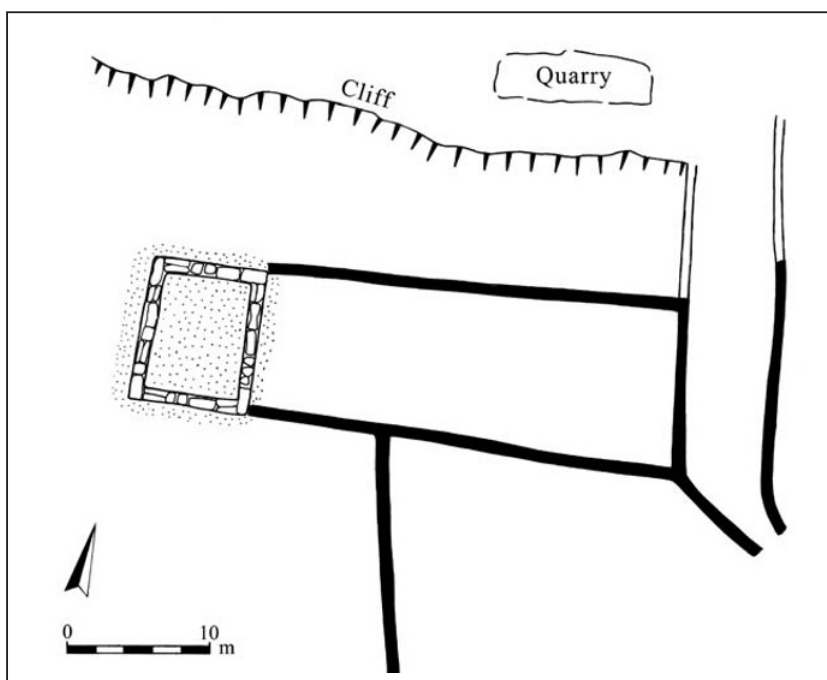
The structure stands on a terrace on a slope. Attached to it to the east is a large courtyard (30×10 m) built of low walls, to which other walls abut. North and close to the complex there is a cliff and a quarry.

Neither the structure nor the site are mentioned in the British Survey.

The structure was erected in the Hellenistic or Early Roman period upon an earlier site, and was used as a farmhouse or imposing tomb.

**Pottery:** Persian – 25%; Hellenistic – 15%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 20%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



114. Plan of the structure and courtyards at Wadi Yahmur, 1998.

Site 85: 16-20/08/1

**Khirbet esh-Sheikh Barṭa'ah** (on the British Survey map – Bertah)

|                                      |                                                     |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1599 2089               | Soil quality: 6                                     |
| UTM grid: 6976 5950                  | Cultivation: none                                   |
| Elevation: 312 m a.s.l., 90 m a.s.a. | Cisterns: 9                                         |
| Name type: appears on map as ancient | Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20), 400 m distant |
| Site type: small village on tell     | Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 3.5 km distant             |
| Area: 9 dunams (9000 sq. m)          | Visibility: 9                                       |
| Topography: high summit              | Date of visit: Nov., Dec. 1978;                     |
| Rock type: Judah group               | 60 sherds                                           |
| Soil type: terra rossa               |                                                     |

The tell, upon which a group of houses stand, rises on a steep rocky hilltop above the Barṭa'ah range, which is located in a system of ridges extending westward to the Barqai-Ma'anit region, about 3.5 km south of Wadi 'Arah. There is a good view from it of the northern coastal plain and southern Carmel. West of the summit is a fertile valley of a few hundred dunams, in which the houses of the modern village of Barṭa'ah are located.

On the summit, parts of the tell are still visible. Among them are an earthen rampart and a wall that apparently once enclosed the summit, and remains of a few walls. On the summit, supported by ancient walls, is a large house, perhaps from the Ottoman period. Around it new buildings have been built which occupy most of the tell. Many sherds are scattered over the slopes, in particular from the Iron Age. In the eastern slope, under the wall line, is a large, rock-cut cave. The tomb of Sheikh Barṭa'ah, on the hilltop, is marked by an ancient oak tree.

The village does not appear in the 1596 Ottoman census. According to Grossman (1986: 345) it was settled 100–150 years ago (seven or eight generations ago) by the Kabha family from the Bet Jibrin region, which had previously lived in Ya'bad. The British Survey people describe: "Bertah – A ruined Arabic village on a high hill, with a spring in the valley to the north 400 feet below" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 51). In the 1931 census there were 692 residents and 94 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 90). Gophna and Porath (1972: site 5) described: "a steep hilltop on the top of which are several structures belonging to an Arab family. A structure-less sheikh's grave marked by a tree of Sheikh Barṭa'ah."

At the end of the 19<sup>th</sup> century there was a citron (*etrog*) grove at the site that supplied fruit to the Jews of Jerusalem. This is the description of Y.M. Salomon, who went to visit Barṭa'ah in 1878: "There [in Qalansuwa] we rested until the afternoon, and set out for the garden known as Barta'ah. This road took me into a forest where trees grew, pistachio and oak, whose branches grew and prospered well... We encountered a group of oak trees whose branches were so twisted that we could not pass, so that we could not believe that a human had trodden on these paths. And when the light of the sun dimmed, the sight of the garden of Barta'ah lit our eyes. Through a narrow entrance we entered the garden, which was in great neglect and most of which was untended. The gentiles who owned the garden of Barta'ah welcomed us with peace, in the tradition of the Eastern peoples who tend to use flattery. And so we succeeded in examining all the trees, but we could not finish all the trees on that day because night fell, and the darkness of the night covered the valley. Afterwards we went to sleep until morning. And we quickly took the road from there to the garden of Shara'iyah." (Vilnay 1960: 51).

There are many stories about Sheikh Barṭa'ah and his cave (Meron and Kabha 1993: 130–133, 139–140). According to a modern source, Sheikh Bartawi served in the army of Salah ed-Din against the Crusaders (Meron and Kabha 1993: 139).

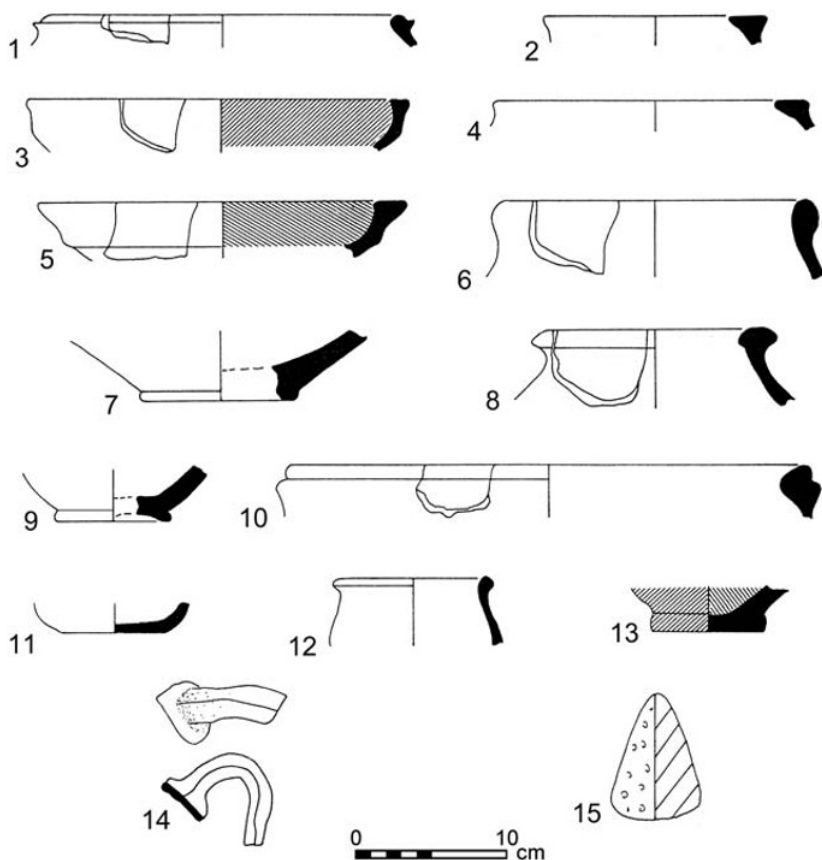


115. The tell of Khirbet esh-Sheikh Barṭa'ah looking south-east. 1999. Photo: M. Weinberg.

**Pottery:** Iron I – 20%; Iron II – 30%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 5%; Byzantine – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 5; Ne'eman 1990: site 22.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: 87; Salem 2006: sites 21, 40.



116. Finds from Khirbet esh-Sheikh Barṭa'ah: 1. CP, brn, IA II; 2. Krater, brn, IA II; 3, 5. Bowls, brn-pk, rd slip, IA II-III; 4. Krater, brn, IA I; 6. Pithos, dk, IA I; 7. Jug base, brn, IA I-II; 8. Jug, brn-gr, IA II; 9. Jug base, gr, IA I; 10. CP, brn, IA II; 11. Jug base, brn, IA I; 12. Jug, lt, IA II; 13. Jug base, rd slip, MA; 14. Jar handle, blk, Byz; 15. Weight, basalt.



Site 86: 16-20/58/1

## Khirbet Ṭurah esh-Sharqiyeh

Israel grid: 1654 2080

UTM grid: 7031 5943

Elevation: 401 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and appears on map

Site type: large ruin or tell

Area: 40 dunams (4 ha)

Topography: flat hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 10

Water source: Bir ej-Jinneḥ (no. 154), 500 m distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), next to site

Visibility: 7

Date of visit: Nov. 1997; 102 sherds

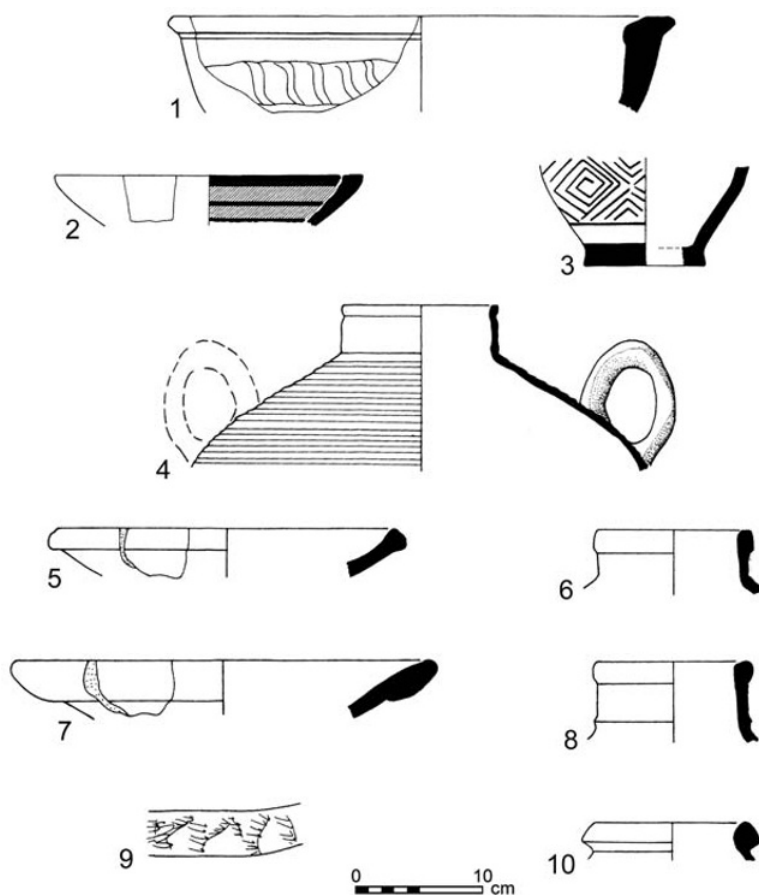
A large site on a flat hilltop on the Shaqed-Riḥan Plateau, just west of the Ya'bad-Ti'inik road and about 1 km south-south-west of the settlement of Shaqed. The place is only partially inhabited today.



117. Bird's-eye view of Kh. Ṭurah esh-Sharqiyeh, looking west – 1998. In the centre is the Medieval site (grove and Ottoman houses), extending over the larger site from the Persian period. At left, in vineyards, Persian-Roman period site continues. Road leads west to Ṭurah el-Gharbiyah. Photo: M. Weinberg.

In the core of the site are two large houses from the Ottoman period (150 years ago according to the residents), built of dry masonry. The houses are roofed with plastered stone domes, and most of the openings are arched. Nearby to the east are more stone houses, built later. The entire ancient core is deserted today, and the residents, the Zeid el-Keilani family, have gone to live in a new house nearby.

The site is divided through the middle by the entrance road leading to the modern village of Ṭurah esh-Sharqiyeh. In its upper part, about 10 dunams (1 ha) in area, surrounded by a high terrace wall, there are



118. Pottery from Kh. Ṭurah esh-Sharqiyeh: 1. Basin, dk gr, MA; 2. Bowl, rd-blk slip, MA; 3. Jug, brn dec on cream, Mam (MA); 4. Jar, dk, Byz; 5, 7. Bowls, yel, Pers; 6. Jar, yel, Pers; 8. Jar, brn, Byz; 9. Rim dec, MA; 10. Jar, yel, Pers.

considerable sherd scatters from the Middle Ages and later. There are also many building stones, cisterns and a few installations. The later settlement was in this area. The outer part of the site (the external circumference) is surrounded by a kind of low rampart. The whole area in front of it, between the modern core and the rampart, is strewn with pottery from the Persian, Hellenistic, and Roman-Byzantine periods. North of the road is another part of the site within an olive grove. At the north-west corner a wall of monumental stones with hewn edges has been preserved, standing to a height of three stone courses, which appears to be part of a Roman family tomb.

The site does not appear in the British Survey. In the emergency survey it is noted that its area is about 3 dunams (3000 sq. m) only. The surveyors found sherds from Iron Age II, which we did not find in our survey (Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 6).

**Pottery:** in the central core - Persian – 15%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 10%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 30%; Ottoman – 10%. In the site's outer circle - Persian – 50%; Hellenistic – 20%; Late Roman – 30%.

**Previous surveys:** Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 6.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 95; Salem 2006: site 333.



Site 87: 15-20/37/1

## Khirbet Naşur

Israel grid: 1535 2074

UTM grid: 6912 5935

Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: tell

Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Water source: Assawir Springs  
(no. 19), 2.5 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.5 km  
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: 1992; 50 sherds

Small tell on a hill among low hills and about 300 m north-east of Kibbutz Ma'anit. The cross-country Israel road (Route 6) now passes over its

eastern part.

The tell extends over the southern and eastern parts of the hill. In the north a relatively steep slope containing caves descends from the hilltop. On the eastern slope of the tell, facing a ravine, a built rampart is discernible, which may have been the fortification line of the place. On top of the tell there are some quarrying and water cisterns.

The tell is not mentioned in the British Survey, on the PEF map, or on maps from the British Mandate period.

In 1997 an emergency excavation was carried out on the eastern slope by Yannai (2010). In this dig a 2 m thick wall was found, possibly used for fortification, and abutted by rooms. Most of the sherds in the dig were from the Persian period. In a probe on the top of the tell, remains from the transition stage from the Wadi Rabah Culture to the Chalcolithic period were exposed, including structures with walls built of bricks on stone foundations (Kalaily and Marder 2010: 12).

In the years 1996–1997 and 2002 salvage excavations in the vicinity of the site were carried out by Yannai, Tueg and Oren (Yannai 2010). The main feature exposed was a large, mainly Hellenistic, courtyard structure. The pottery and coins were dated to the Persian, Hellenistic, Early Roman, and Byzantine periods. In the fills outside the structure were found sherds from the Late Bronze Age, Iron Age, Byzantine, and Mamluk periods. Next to the



119. Khirbet Naşur, looking west, 1992. Photo: A. Zertal.

structure were cup-marks, pits, and installations. Three winepresses with rectangular or oval crushing surfaces were also uncovered. At the eastern part of Kibbutz Barkai two rock-cut burial caves, quarries of varying sizes, and five winepresses were found, all dated to the Byzantine period.

**Pottery** (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Chalcolithic; Late Bronze; Iron I; Iron II; Persian; Hellenistic; Early Roman; Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 25.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 98; Ariel 2010; Bijovsky 2010; Winter 2010.



Site 88: 16-20/28/1

## Riḥan

Israel grid: 1625 2085

UTM grid: 7002 5947

Elevation: 387 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir ej-Jinneḥ  
(no. 154), 2.2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16),  
2 km distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: 1992

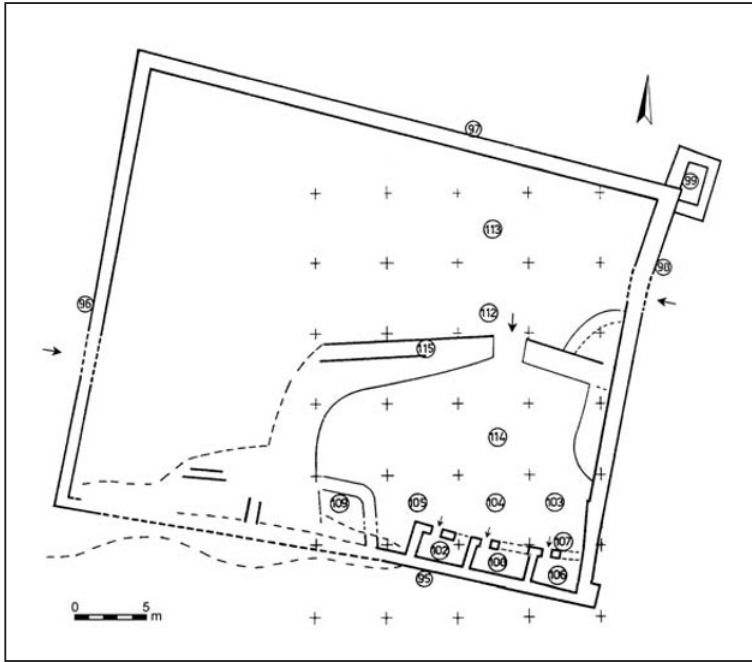
A site in the centre of Moshav Riḥan, on a prominent hilltop overlooking Wadi Yaḥmur. It was excavated by the Umm Riḥan expedition (Dar et al. 1986: 107–109). A rectangular farmhouse was found, 30×38 m, with installations. The outer wall is made of slightly worked limestone. The walls, about 1.5 m thick, were preserved to a height of 1.5 m. Along the southern wall three small rooms were discovered, and apparently there were additional rooms under the heap of fallen stones next to the same wall.

According to the excavators, there were 10 to 15 rooms along the walls of the courtyard, and the rest of the area served for storage and keeping livestock. In the north-eastern corner outside the wall, the foundations of a small tower were found. The floor of the courtyard is made of levelled bedrock.

**Pottery:** Persian – 70%; Hellenistic – 30%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dar et al. 1986: 3–4, 175–176.



120. Plan of Riḥan (Dar et al 1986: fig. 47).



Site 89: 15-20/17/1

## Lovzovski Hill

Israel grid: 1519 2072

UTM grid: 6896 5932

Elevation: 45 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: flat hilltop

Rock type: alluvium cover

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 9

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: Assawir Springs

(no. 19), 2.4 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), near site

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: 1992; 30 sherds

A small site on a flat hilltop in the fields of Kibbutz Ein-Shemer, 1 km east of the kibbutz and close to the road Baqa el-Gharbiyeh–'Iron junction.

In the centre of the field, following deep ploughing, sherds and basalt tools as well as a few possible walls were discovered. Apparently houses once stood on the spot.

**Pottery:** Early Bronze I – 100%

**Previous surveys:** None.



Site 90: 15-20/47/1

## El-Meiyadin

Israel grid: 1549 2079

UTM grid: 6926 5940

Elevation: 138 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2.7 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Dec. 1991; Jan. 1992;  
35 sherds

A farm on the southern moderate slope of a prominent hilltop (E.P. 143), in the hilly area south-east of Wadi 'Arah. It is located 500 m south-west of Kh. eṭ-Ṭawilah, and about 1 km west of Umm el-Quṭuf. The modern town of Harish stands there today.

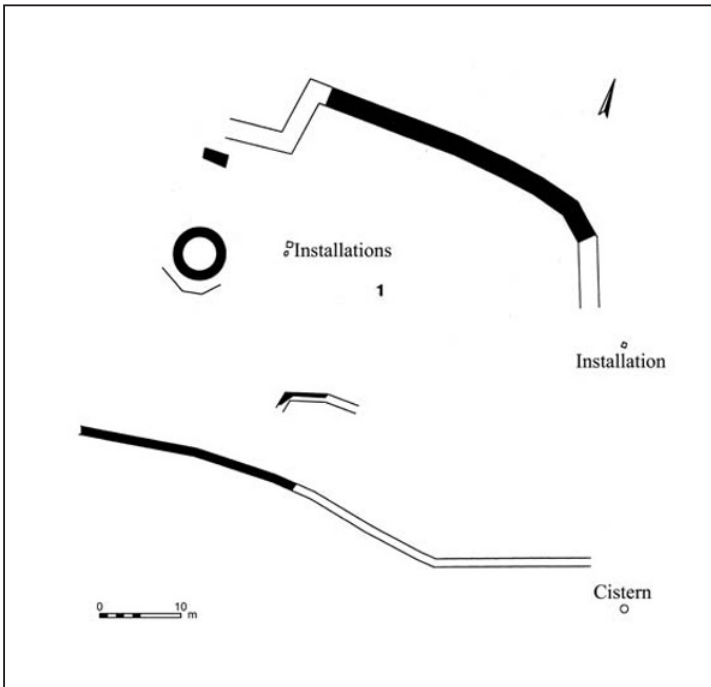
At the site is a large courtyard, a terrace wall and installations. The wall enclosing the courtyard is well preserved in the north. It is 1 m thick and built of two rows of large stones. The northern wall is 30 m long and has two corners, at the north-east and the north-west. Next to the latter, the wall turns south, and ends at a 2 m wide built opening. South of the opening is a structure, about 6×10 m, built of large stones, but its plan could not be drawn due to its ruinous state. A terrace wall was found in the southern part of the site, apparently built as a support wall for levelling the farm area. Installations were found in different parts of the site. In the south-eastern corner is a large water cistern, and to the east of the eastern wall

are three basins or cupmarks.

Here are the remains of an agricultural farm with family home, courtyard and installations. It could have been connected with the nearby Roman sites at Umm el-Quṭuf and Kh. eṭ-Ṭawilah. The place has been completely ruined by modern construction work of the new town of Harish.

**Pottery:** Iron II – 20%; Late Roman – 50%; Byzantine – 30%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



121. Plan of Roman period farm at el-Meiyadin, 1991.



Site 91: 15-20/77/1

## Dhuhur el-Khardal

Israel grid: 1572 2078

UTM grid: 6950 5939

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunam (1500 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2.7 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 3.5 km  
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Nov. 1991; 15 sherds

Remains of a farm on the Dhuhur el-Khardal range, on a northern slope descending to Wadi Mahweh, with a good view of the village of Barṭa'ah. The site is located 1.5 km south-west of the village.

At the top are remains of two adjacent structures built of field stones, apparently from the end of the Ottoman period. The larger one is 4×10 m, with walls preserved to a height of 0.5 m. Below, on the slope and north of the structures, is a large cave that originally served as a cistern, whose top opening has been preserved. At the bottom of the site is a built courtyard of irregular shape.

Ne'eman (1990: site 26) describes it inaccurately, and dates it without foundation to the Byzantine period.

**Pottery:** Ottoman – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 26.

Site 92: 16-20/17/1

## **El-Munṭar** (British Survey: Khurbet el-Munṭar)

Israel grid: 1617 2071

UTM grid: 6994 5933

Elevation: 328 m a.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: fortress/farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: high hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 4

Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20),  
3 km distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 3.3 km  
distant

Visibility: 9

Date of visit: Oct. 1978; Jan. 1998;  
30 sherds

A site on a prominent rocky hill, visible from a great distance and situated about 1 km north-west of Zibdeh. This is one of the best observation points in the region, with an especially good view of the hills of Wadi 'Arah (to the north), the coastal plain (to the west), and to the Baqa el-Gharbiyeh–Dothan Valley road (to the south).

In the centre of the hilltop are two rectangular buildings of large stones. The western one is 6×8 m and stands up to five courses high (2 m). The eastern building is built in the same manner, but is slightly smaller.

The hilltop has been levelled and raised by supporting walls, visible particularly in the north, east and west. All over the surface are various types



122. The hill of el-Munṭar, looking north (from the village of Zibdeh), 1978. Photo: A. Zertal.

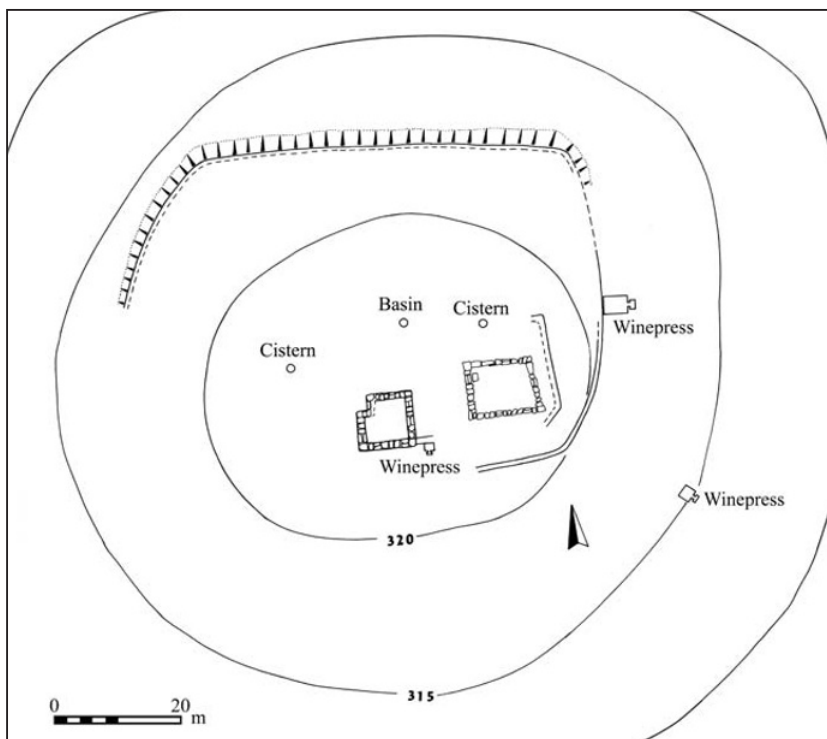
of rock-cut installations, including winepresses, basins, cupmarks, and a cave in secondary use on the eastern slope. Today there are new residential homes on the northern slope.

In the British Survey the place is described as “a square tower of drafted masonry (compare Raba, Sheet XII) – similar to others more particularly described, perhaps of Crusading times” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 61).

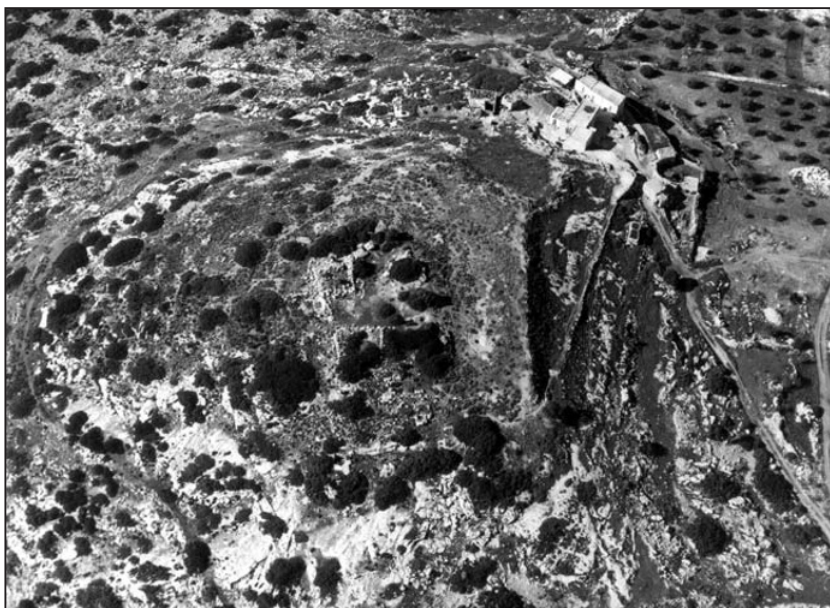
Apparently there was a farm and/or a small lookout stronghold here. In the ravine to the west of the site and on the slope to the south of it are many agricultural installations and structures.

**Pottery:** Iron I – 10%; Hellenistic – 5%; Early Roman – 25%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 50%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



123. Plan of remains at el-Munţar, 1998.



124. Bird's-eye view of el-Munţar, looking west, 1998.



125. The structure of el-Munţar being surveyed, 1998.

Site 93: 15-20/36/1

**Khirbet Beidus** (erroneously marked on the Israeli map as Tel Narbata)

Israel grid: 1532 2068

UTM grid: 6910 5928

Elevation: 75 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as historic site

Site type: large ruin

Area: 40 dunams (4 ha)

Topography: hilltop on fringe of valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 13

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140), 2.8 km distant

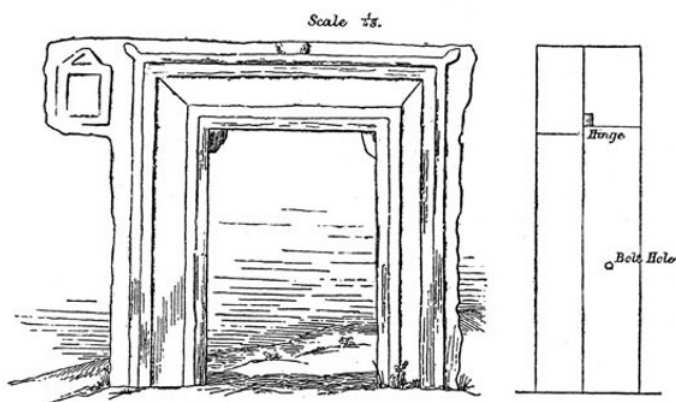
Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Dec. 1992, many visits; 108 sherds

A large site on a hilltop and its slopes, in the first hilly range bordering the Sharon plain in the east. Today it is on the eastern edge of Kibbutz Ma'anit, within a planted pine forest.

On the rounded hilltop in the centre of the ancient site there is a modern watchtower and a large courtyard-house, inside which is an entrance-way described in the British Survey. Around it are many more well-built courtyard-houses of field stones and ashlar in an advanced stage of deterioration. On the surface are many architectural items. Over the years

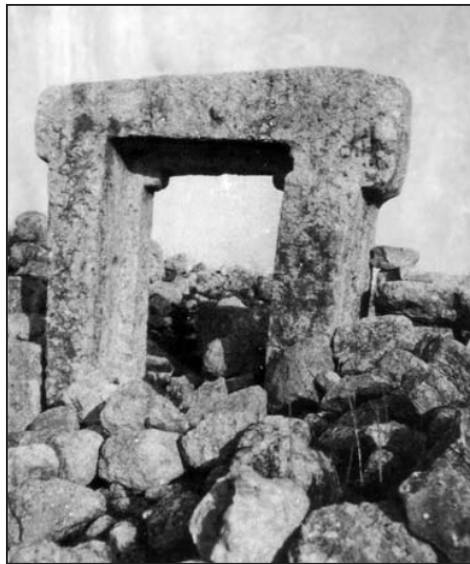


126. Stone doorway at Khirbet Beidus as sketched by the British Survey in April 1873 (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 57).

many burial caves were excavated and their contents are displayed in the museum of Kibbutz Ma'anit.

At the foot of the hill on which the tell is located, to its north-east and east, are remains of caves that were used for residence, wine production, and burial; also found were rock-cut bell-like water cisterns, columbaria, and winepresses. The main winepress discovered had a crushing surface (7.2×6.1 m) cut in the rock, a sump pit (1.4×1.3×0.8 m), and two square (3×3×1.3 m and 2.3×2.3×1.4 m) collecting vats, the smaller one paved with white mosaic. In the eastern walls of both vats two stairs are cut. Additional smaller winepresses are north of the main one (crushing surfaces 3.5×3 m, and collecting vats approximately 1.5×1 m). It is likely that the main winepress was for public use and was cut towards the end of the Byzantine period. The smaller winepresses, possibly private, were probably cut in the Roman period (Ne'eman 1990: sites 24, 29).

To the west and north-east are remains of two columbaria. South of the tell is an elliptical enclosure, roughly 100×55–65 m, built of a massive wall, 2.5–2.8 m thick, and preserved to a height of 1.5 m. An ancient well and a pool (3.7×3.3×1.8 m deep) were found on the northern side of this enclosure. The pottery here, outside the ancient core of the site, is from the Roman, Byzantine, Early Moslem, and Ottoman periods.



127. Photo of the stone arch at Khirbet Beidus, 1945 (?). Courtesy of Kibbutz Ma'anit archives.

In the British Survey it is described: “Traces of a ruined village, a cave, a cistern, and a pillar shaft, exist here, with a doorway hewn out of one piece of stone. The total height of this doorway is 8 feet 1 inch; the total breadth about 9 feet. The door is 6 feet high, 4 feet broad in the clear. A moulding in low relief runs round it, and at one end of the lintel is a tablet in low relief. There is a socket for the pivot of the door, and a hole for a bolt. The whole is cut out of a block of yellowish hard limestone containing many fossils, and quarried nearby. The workmanship is rough, and seems unfinished. Some blocks of the wall are visible *in situ* on the right. The doorway faces approximately west (3 degrees 30’ true bearing). It may have belonged to an early chapel. Visited 9<sup>th</sup> April, 1873.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 57-58).

On this site once stood a large well-developed town from the Roman-Byzantine period.

**Pottery** (in the ancient town): Iron II – 10%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 20%; Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 20%.

**Identification:** Mazar (Maisler 1934: 97) first suggested identifying the site as Narbatah of Josephus Flavius (War II xiv, 5; xviii, 10). Mazar’s identification was generally accepted. Following the discovery and excavation of Kh. el-Ḥammam, it appears that this suggestion is no longer valid: see comprehensive discussion in Chapter 2.

**Previous surveys:** Ne’eman 1990: sites 24, 29.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 110.



Site 94: 15-20/46/1

## Umm edh-Dhiyab (in British Survey El-Medhiab)

|                                               |                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1545 2063                        | Soil quality: 4                                      |
| UTM grid: 6922 5923                           | Cultivation: none                                    |
| Elevation: 114 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.          | Cisterns: 10                                         |
| Name type: appears on map as<br>historic site | Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),<br>1.3 km distant |
| Site type: tell                               | Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2 km<br>distant             |
| Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)                        | Visibility: 7                                        |
| Topography: high hilltop                      | Date of visit: Jan. 1992; 45 sherds                  |
| Rock type: Mount Scopus formation             |                                                      |
| Soil type: terra rossa                        |                                                      |

A tell on a high isolated hilltop, on the border between the Qaffin–Metzer valley and the hilly area north of it. The site is about 1.5 km south-east of Kibbutz Ma'anit and 1 km north of Kibbutz Metzer.

The place is surrounded by a terrace wall about 5 m high, clearly visible in the north and east. On the upper part was discerned another wall, 1.2 m thick, made of large stones, which apparently served as a fortification. Two structures project from the eastern part of the fortification line, possibly towers. The wall is missing in the south, while in the west of the site it looks like a terrace wall.

On the site are quite a number of rock-cut caves and cisterns. Worthy of mention are a cave in the north-east and another cave, used for burial, in the north of the place. Both were plundered, and both have an entrance hall in front of their opening. There are more caves in the southern part of the site.

On the high surface inside the wall at least ten structures were found, with walls made of large cut stones. Apparently these buildings belong to later periods of the settlement (Roman-Byzantine).

From the north-eastern part of the site a well-built road stretches for at least 500 m. It is 3 m wide, and is built of two rows of large stones. The road passes over the northern slope of a hill, E.P. 129.

Within the boundaries of the site and around it were found a number of rock-cut basins and other installations. The British Survey found “walls and foundations” here (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 67).

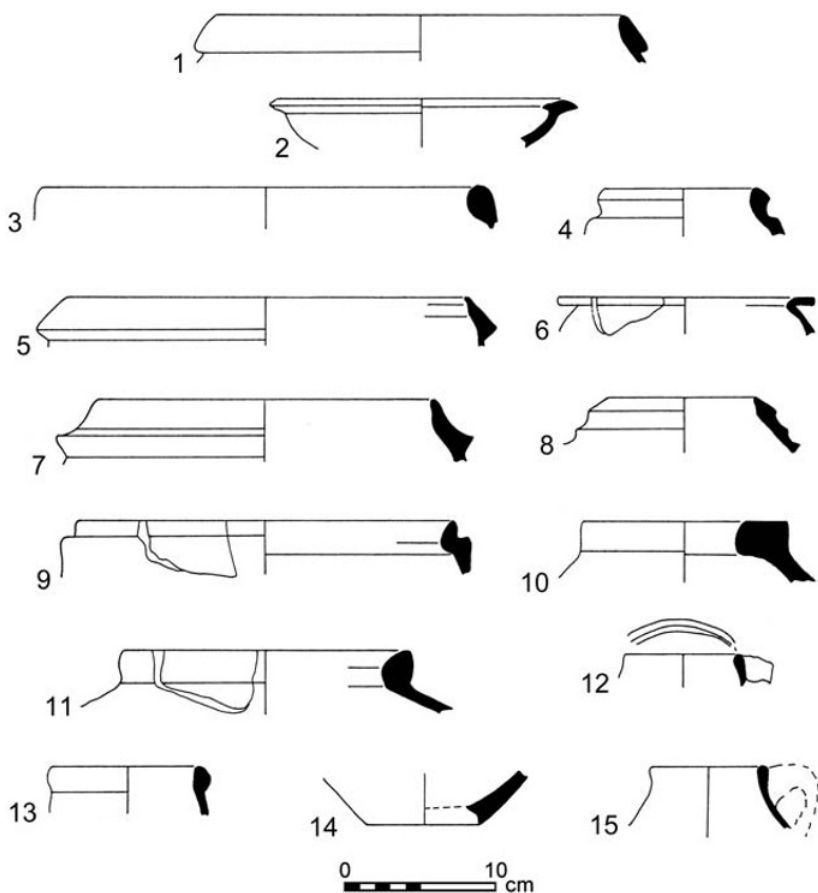
**Pottery:** Iron I – 20%; Iron II – 42%; Persian – 15%; Hellenistic – 10%;



Roman – 11%; Byzantine – 2%.

Previous surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 30.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 107.



128. Pottery from Umm edh-Dhiyab: 1. Krater, lt brn, IA I; 2. Bowl, brn, IA II; 3. Krater, dk gr, IA I; 4. Jar, gr, IA II; 5. CP, brn, IA Ib; 6. Bowl, lt brn, ER; 7. CP, brn, IA Ic; 8. Jar, brn, IA II; 9. CP, dk brn, IA II; 10. HM, yel, Pers; 11. Krater, gr, IA I; 12. Jug, gr, ER; 13. Jar, yel, Pers; 14. Jug base, brn, IA II; 15. Jug, lt brn, LR.

Site 95: 15-20/66/1

## Khirbet Mahu

Israel grid: 1567 2068

UTM grid: 6945 5929

Elevation: 148 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient

Site type: large, fortified

Area: 14 dunams (1.4 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

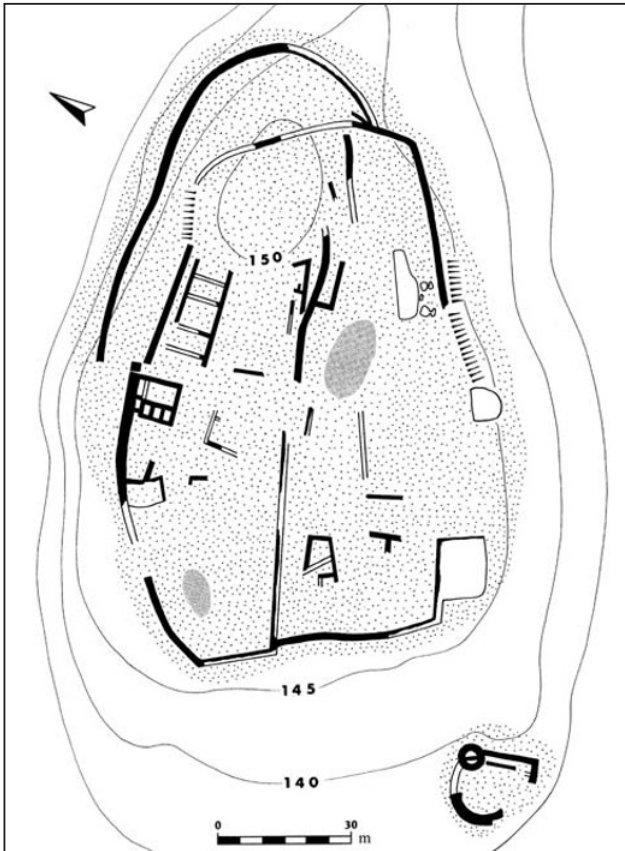
Cisterns: 4

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
1.8 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqa (C14),  
next to site

Visibility: 5

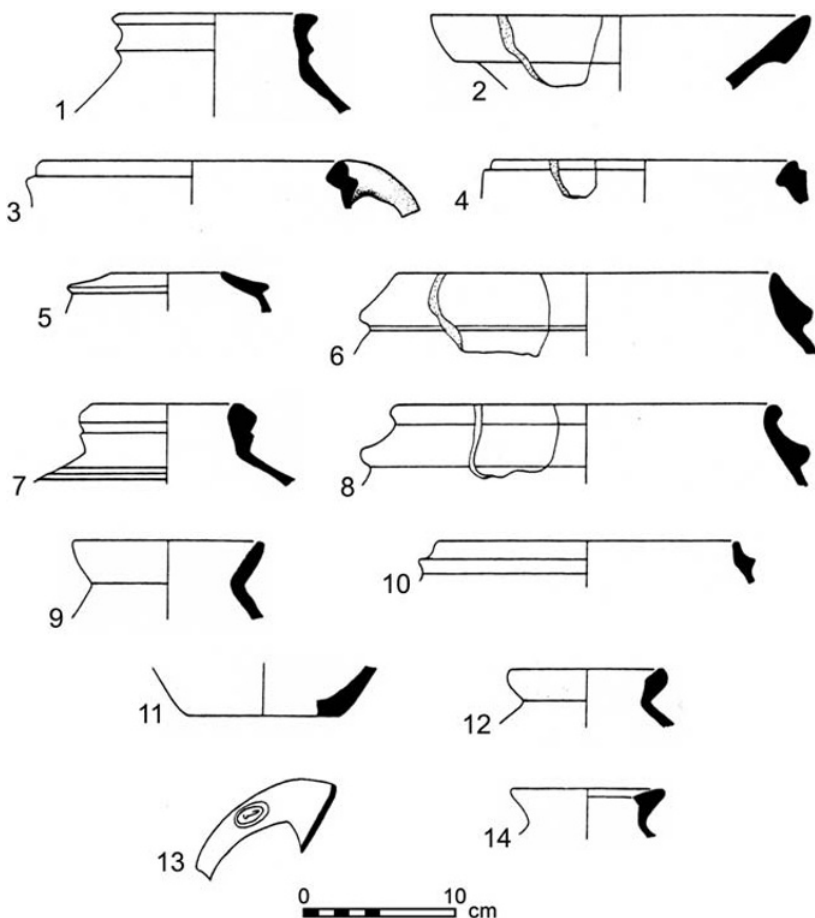
Date of visit: Aug. 1991; 70 sherds



129. Plan of the Iron Age II fortified site at Khirbet Mahu, 1991.

A fortified site on a flat hilltop elevated above its environs, in the hilly area 2 km south-west of Barṭa'ah. An important road passes by the foot of the site. The northern slope is especially steep; the hilltop is attached to its environs by a saddle on the eastern side.

The place is surrounded by a stone wall about 1.5 m thick, built of two rows of large stones with a fill of small stones. It encompasses the site on three sides, partly missing in the south. Along the wall, two structures covered by cleared stones were found. Several more structures and walls were



130. Pottery from Khirbet Mahu: 1. Jar, brn, IA II; 2. Bowl, yel, Pers; 3-4. CP, brn, IA II; 5. HM, gr, IA II; 6, 8. CP, dk, IA Ic; 7. Jar, lt brn, IA II; 9. Jar, lt, Hel (?); 10. CP, brn, IA Ic; 11. Bowl base, yel, Pers; 12. Jar, lt brn, IA II; 13. Stamp on jar handle, IA II; 14. Jar, lt, MB II (?).

found on the surface, also covered by cleared stones. The place is divided by an inner wall into upper (northern) and lower (southern) parts. About 50 m south-west of the outer wall is another complex of buildings, and next to it is a sherds scatter from the Iron Age only and a cistern or rock-cut cave.

This is an Iron Age fortified city. It does not appear on the British Survey lists. Ne'eman (1990: site 31) wrote: "Eroded ruin on rocky hill. At edge of site, to the east – a bell-shaped rock-hewn cistern". In addition to the name Kh. el-Mahweh he mentions the name Kh. el Mahwa which appears in British Mandate maps and in the British Survey map.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze II – 2%; Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 88%; Persian-Hellenistic – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 31.



Site 96: 15-20/66/2

## el-Wakr

|                                      |                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1568 2065               | Cultivation: field crops                             |
| UTM grid: 6946 5926                  | Cisterns: 6                                          |
| Elevation: 105 m a.s.l., 20 m b.s.a. | Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),<br>1.8 km distant |
| Name type: ancient, but not on map   | Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqā (C14),<br>1 km distant      |
| Site type: large                     | Visibility: 2                                        |
| Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)               | Date of visit: Sept., Oct. 1991;                     |
| Topography: ravine                   | 54 sherds                                            |
| Rock type: Mount Scopus formation    |                                                      |
| Soil type: terra rossa               |                                                      |
| Soil quality: 6                      |                                                      |

A large site in the area of low hills south of Wadi 'Arah and about 2 km north-east of Kibbutz Metzger. Just north-west of it lies the fortified site of Khirbet Mahu.

The slope and ravine over which the site extends are east of the E.P. 126. The site's houses were mainly in the ravine descending in the direction of Kh. 'Aqqabeh. Today the remains are found in a large open space on the slope, between olive groves.

There are some remains of walls, built of especially large stones. Most

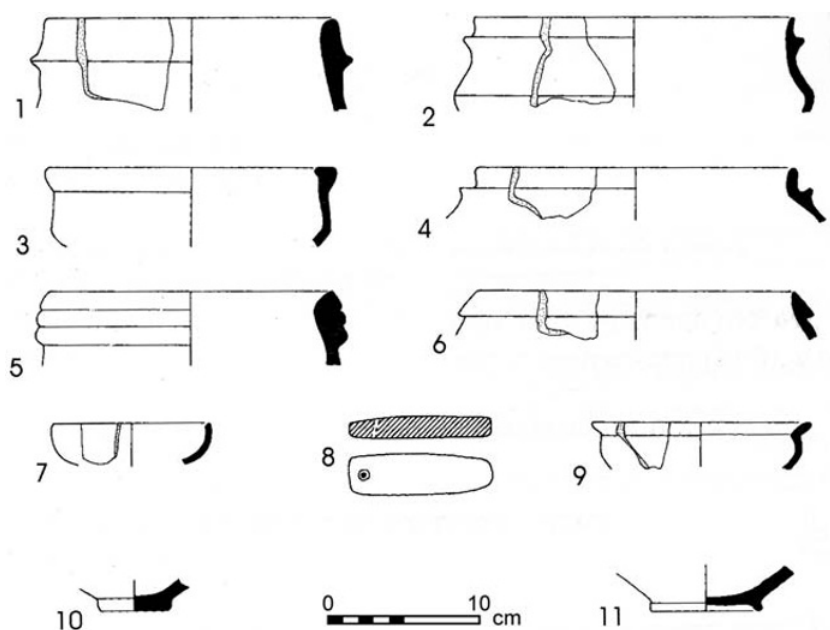
of the stones were removed by a bulldozer and piled up. On the upper part of the slope, to the west and within the olive orchards, are more walls of large stones. On the upper part an array of pit openings were found, each connected to the next. These are apparently burial cave openings.

E.P. 126 to the west seems to have served as the cemetery for the residents of nearby Kh. Mahu. It may be that the settlement was the first stage of this adjacent fortified city.

The sherds found at the site were mostly from the Iron Age Ib (12<sup>th</sup>–11<sup>th</sup> centuries BCE), but Late Bronze Age sherds were also found.

**Pottery:** Late Bronze – 10%; Iron I – 90%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



131. Finds from el-Wakr: 1. Pithos, gr, IA I; 2, 4. CP, brn, IA Ib; 3. Bowl, brn, IA I; 5. Pithos, brn gr, IA I; 6. CP, dk, IA Ib; 7. Small bowl, lt, LB; 8. Weight, sandstone; 9–11. Bowls, lt, LB–IA I.

Site 97: 15-20/76/1

## Esh-Shawmarah

Israel grid: 1577 2068

UTM point: 6955 5930

Elevation: 152 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient

Site type: farm

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2.2 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqa (C14),  
1.2 km distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Nov. 1991; 13 sherds

A farm on a hilltop above Wadi Fadil, 2 km south-west of Barṭa'ah. From here is a fine view of the Qatzir Range and the Barṭa'ah region.

The remains include an irregular courtyard about 40 m in diameter. A rectangular structure, 4×12 m, containing two rooms, is attached to the east side of the courtyard. The rooms have entrances facing west onto the courtyard. On the western part of the latter is a smaller structure, also comprising two rooms, the southernmost of which has an additional subdivision and a collapsed stone arch.

In the south-west of the courtyard is another structure, 3×10 m, with three rooms. There are many installations on the site: on the western part of



132. The structure at Esh-Shawmarah, 1991, with A. Ziv and N. Mirkam.

the courtyard is a large, rock-cut winepress with a place for treading grapes and a plastered collecting pit about 1.5 m deep. South of the winepress is a water cistern. In the eastern part of the courtyard are more installations and two cupmarks. The construction is mortar-less, of small stones, with walls 40 cm wide, preserved to a height of 2 m.

According to two local elders, the farm was founded in the 1940s by one of the residents of Kh. 'Aqqabeh. It was deserted in the 1960s.

This is a fine example of construction of a traditional Arab farmstead.

**Pottery:** Modern – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



Site 98: 16-20/06/1

## Dhahr el-'Abd

Israel grid: 1602 2062

UTM grid: 6980 5924

Elevation: 224 m a.s.l., 17 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 3

Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20),  
3 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqā (C14),  
3 km distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Oct. 1978; 39 sherds

A farm in a narrow ravine, north-east of E.P. 224, in the area of low hills south of Kh. Barṭa'ah and half-way between Ya'bad and Wadi 'Arah. West of the ruin, a new village has recently been founded, named Dhahr el-'Abd.

The site includes an especially large courtyard, about 25×40 m, surrounded by a low stone wall. Within the courtyard, close to the western wall, remains were found of two structures whose plan was blurred by piles of cleared stones. Further along the slope going northward, there are built terraces, and between them and the buildings are rock-cut installations and cisterns. The construction, of cut field stones, is good. Two caves were found on the western slope.

This is a typical farmstead from the Roman-Byzantine periods.

**Pottery:** Late Roman – 50%; Byzantine – 40%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 32.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 108; Salem 2006: site 72.



Site 99: 16-20/26/1

## Tell esh-Sheikh Şabar

Israel grid: 1619 2061

UTM grid: 6997 5923

Elevation: 268 m a.s.l., 45 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 35 dunams (3.5 ha)

Topography: hilltop on edge of ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: olives (partial)

Cisterns: 11

Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20),  
3.8 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2.5 km  
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: 1978-1980; Oct. 1997;

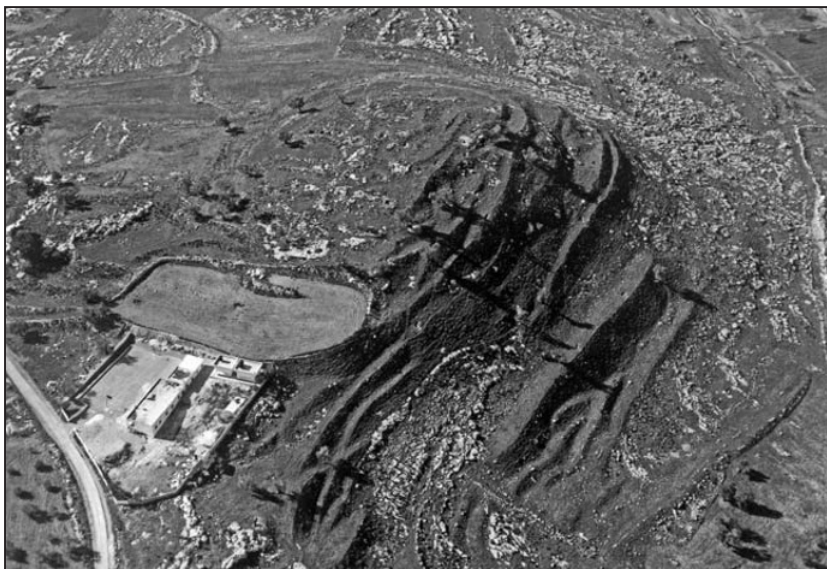
120 sherds

A tell in the area of low hills north-west of the Dothan Valley, about 500 m south-west of Zibdeh. The road from Ya'bad to Barṭa'ah passes by the southern foothills of the tell. Steep slopes descend from it to the wadis in the north and east, and the easiest approach is by the saddle from the south-west side.

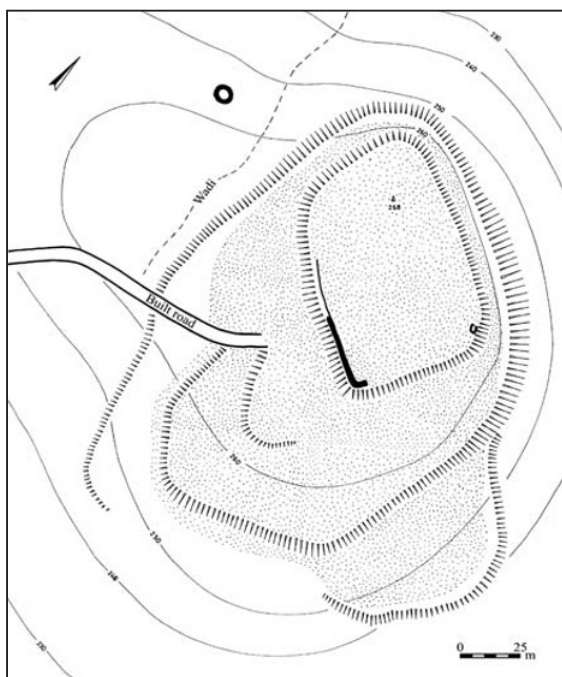
The fortified tell extends mostly over the hill of E.P. 268. At the top of the hill is an acropolis fortified by a wall, about 7 dunams (7000 sq. m) in area. The fortification wall is 2 m thick, and under it are high terraces, surrounding the acropolis on all sides. This, together with more terraces, creates a kind of lower 'quarter' on the south side of the tell. The north-eastern slope is also nicely graduated by built terraces, mostly ancient. The terraces range in height from 2 to 4 m, and judging by the wall remains, it can be assumed that the houses of the site stood on top of them.

In various places, on the steps of the northern and eastern slopes, there are broad areas on which structures are partially preserved, walls of field-stones, quarried places and caves. On the upper slopes were exceptionally large sherd scatters from the Iron Age and fewer sherds from later periods.





133. Bird's-eye view of the site, looking north-east, 1997. Photo: M. Weinberg.

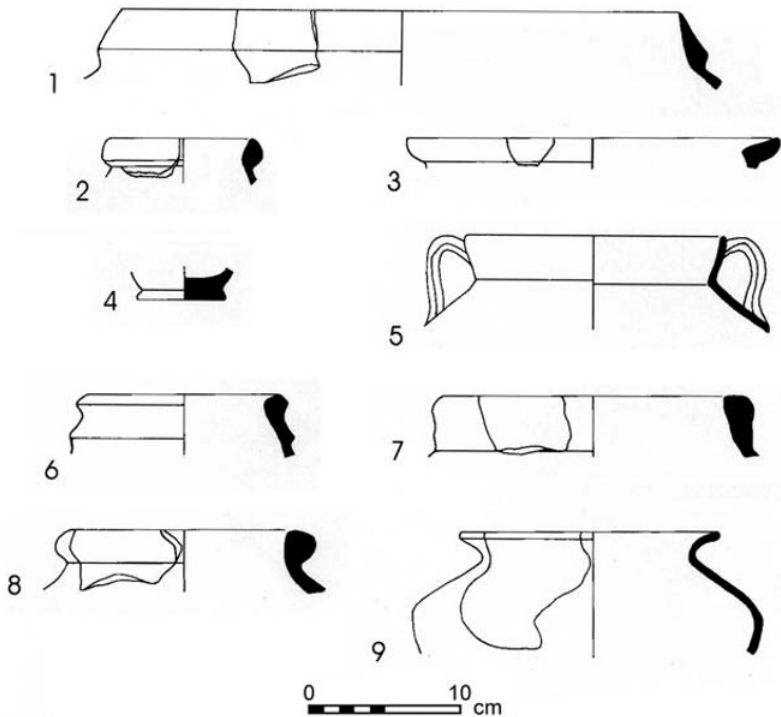


134. Plan of tell of esh-Sheikh Šabar, 1998.

Apparently the settlement spread over all the slopes during Iron Age I-II, but reached its maximum size during the Hellenistic and Early Roman periods.

On the hilltop are remains of large structures, which were greatly disturbed by later activity. Two courtyard-houses were found here, covered by cleared stones, and next to them many rock-cut and built agricultural installations, winepresses and cellars, pits, quarried places, and burial caves. One of these last, plundered, includes two sets of niches, one above the other. In this area is a concentration of Late Roman and Byzantine sherds. Possibly during these periods the settlement had shrunk, and was concentrated mainly on the hilltop.

A 6 m wide built road that leads to the tell crosses the southern saddle and enters what was apparently the gateway.



135. Pottery from Tell esh-Sheikh Şabar: 1.CP, dk, IA I; 2.Jug, yel, Pers-Hel; 3.Bowl, gr, IA II; 4.Jug base, lt, IA II; 5.CP, brn, LR; 6.Jar, gr, IA II; 7.Pithos, lt gr, IA I; 8.Jar, gr, IA II; 9.CP, brn, LB-IA I.

Tel esh-Sheikh Şabar was an important site during the Iron Age in the region, and existed as a settlement centre, together with Tel 'Abeideh, the tells in the Dothan Valley (Dothan, Hephher and Yibleam) and on the Sharon boundary (Jatt, Kh. Isyar, Tel Esur). It flourished primarily in the Early Roman period, and is similar in some features to Kh. el-Ḥamam (Narbatāh).

**Pottery:** Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 15%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 20%; Early Roman – 35%; Late Roman – 5%; Byzantine – 10%.

**Identification:** The tell's size, its importance during the Iron Age, and the preservation of the name in the village of Zibdeh, enable identification of this site as Zevad/Zevadya, a name that occurs several times in various sources; see Chapter 2.

**Previous surveys:** None.

**Bibliography:** Salem 2006: site 311.



Site 100: 16-20/26/2

**Zibdeh** (on British Survey map: Zebdah)

Israel grid: 1625 2063

UTM grid: 7002 5926

Elevation: 282 m a.s.l., 34 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not as  
historic site

Site type: village on ruin

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha) – ancient  
core

Topography: hilltop on edge of ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 40

Water source: Bir ej-Jinneḥ  
(no. 154), 3.5 km distant

Road: Jatt–Ta'anach (A3), 2.3 km  
distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: Feb. 1979; 60 sherds

A medium-sized Arab village on a large hilltop in the low hilly area between the Dothan Valley and Wadi 'Arah. To the west passes the road from Ya'bad to Barṭa'ah, which also crosses nearby Tel esh-Sheikh Şabar.

The dense ancient core was in the centre of the village, in which are cut, carved and smoothed building stones and a decorated lintel. There are many caves cut in the area, among them some thought to be burial caves, agricultural installations, and others. There are also remnants of ancient

walls, but during modern construction most of the ancient structures were dismantled. In the western and northern part of the village are two mosques with adjacent tombs of sheikhs: Sheikh Nasr and Sheikh Mustafa.

In a document from the year 1200 (Crusader period) there is a mention of *Zebedellum* as one of the estates of Caesarea (Beyer 1936: 37). In the Ottoman census of 1596 there were 26 Moslem taxpayers who paid 3080 *aqia* for wheat, 1040 for barley, 700 for summer crops, 1368 for vineyards, 150 for goats and honeybees, and 30 for an olive press (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159). In the British Survey it is described as "a ruined village with a well" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 72). In the 1931 census there were 132 residents and 22 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 137).

Grossman (1986: 345) claims that the village "was abandoned after the 16<sup>th</sup> century as a result of vengeance or civil war. Possibly the abandonment occurred during the Qeiss-Yamman wars (1840-1860). It was resettled about 100–150 years ago (seven or eight generations)", but his claim does not match the British Survey from 1872, which claims that the village was in ruins. In the Emergency Survey (Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 11) the place is described as "an Arab village on the edge of a ridge, on top of a ruin. The area of the ruin is about 7 dunams. The village covers about a quarter of the ruined area, and the rest is cleared of stones."

**Pottery:** Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 25%; Byzantine – 25%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 15%; Ottoman – 5%.

**Previous surveys:** Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 11.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 105; Salem 2006: site 354.

Site 101: 16-20/46/1

## Er-Ras (en-Nakhleh)

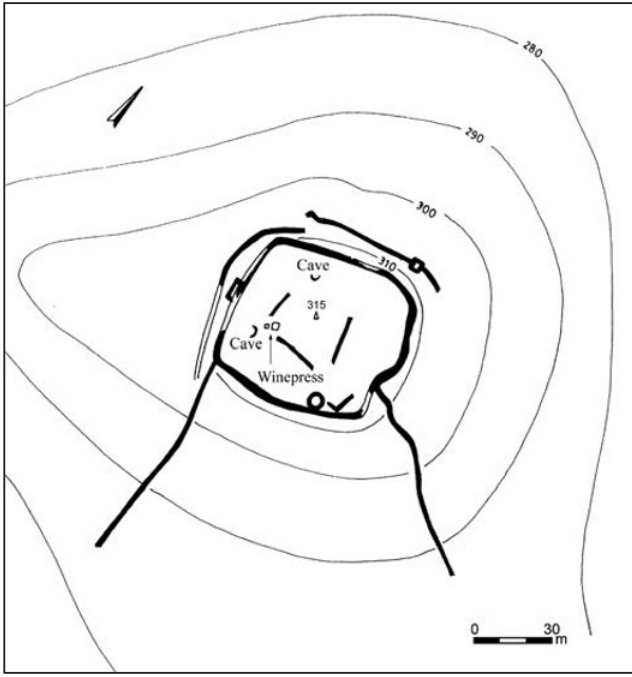
|                                                     |                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1646 2060                              | Soil quality: 4                                                |
| UTM grid: 7024 5923                                 | Cultivation: none                                              |
| Elevation: 315 m a.s.l., 54 m a.s.a.                | Cisterns: 3                                                    |
| Name type: appears on map, but not as historic site | Water source: Bir Jamal (no. 32), 1.2 km distant               |
| Site type: fortress                                 | Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km distant                         |
| Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)                         | Visibility: 5                                                  |
| Topography: hilltop                                 | Date of visit: Oct. 1978; Jan.-Mar. 1979; Nov. 1997; 54 sherds |
| Rock type: Judah group                              |                                                                |
| Soil type: rendzina and brown forest                |                                                                |

A fortress on a high rocky secluded hilltop, rising above the village of Ya'bad. The northern slope of the hilltop, which descends into Wadi 'Asl, is especially steep, as are the slopes to the east and west. It is most convenient to approach the site from the south, where a built path joins the villages of Ya'bad and Zibdeh.

The site is situated on a high rocky place at the top of the rocky hilltop. The hilltop, about 5 dunams (5000 sq. m) in area, is surrounded by wall. The wall forms an irregular, approximately rectangular shape, 70×80 m. It surrounds the summit, is 2.5 m thick, and still stands in some parts (in the north) to a height of 4–5 m. The masonry is of small and medium-sized stones. Today it is used as a supporting wall for the cultivated areas within it, but it clearly served originally for defence.

Beneath the main wall, traces of another, narrower wall (1.2 m thick) were found in the north and west. It surrounds the site about 5–10 m outside the high wall and on the slope is 10 m lower than the latter. In the north there is a break in this second wall, apparently the entrance to the site. Traces of the second wall were not found in the east and south, and it seems to have been dismantled.

The upper part of the summit, an area of one dunam (30×30 m), was apparently surrounded by yet another wall, little of which remains. Possibly it was a supporting wall, the purpose of which was to level the top part of the site. Remains of the other structures have been dismantled, and their stones are discernible here and there. On the rock surfaces in the centre of the site are cut steps that led to one of the structures, as well as a rock-cut winepress and a *kebbarah*, an installation for lime production.



136. Plan of the er-Ras fortress, 1997.



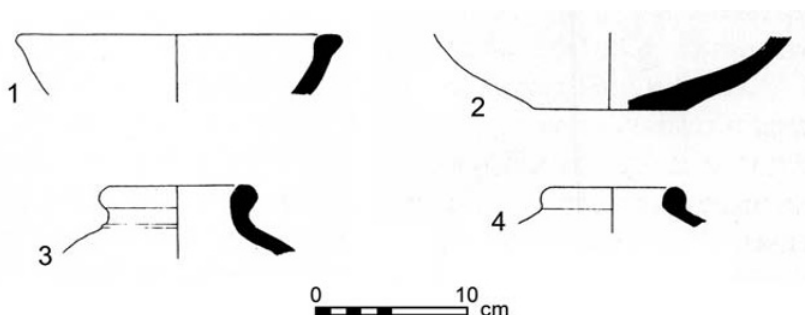
137. Bird's-eye view of the er-Ras fortress, looking east, 1998. Photo: M. Weinberg.

On the northern slope and in the western part of the summit caves are cut. Throughout the site are medium-sized sherd scatters from the Persian period.

According to the location and fortification, it can be surmised that the place served as a fortress protecting the route through Wadi 'Asl and/or in connection with the large tell nearby, Tel 'Abeideh. In addition, the site might possibly have been associated with military activities mentioned in the Book of Judith.

**Pottery:** Persian – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** Zertal 1984: no. 6.



138. Pottery from er-Ras, all Pers: 1.Bowl, gr; 2.Bowl base, yel; 3-4.Jars, gr.



Site 102: 15-20/45/2

### **Esh-Sheikh Meisar** (in British Survey: Sheikh Meisar)

Israel grid: 1542 2056

UTM grid: 6920 5917

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as  
historic site

Site type: Arab village on ruin

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: low hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 40

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
1.5 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), next to  
site

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: many visits during  
1980–1985, 40 sherds



A village on a ruin and a low broad hilltop in an area of plains and hills on the boundary between the Ya'bad Hills and the Sharon Plain. North of the village is Wadi Samantar, and north of that is the range of Umm edh-Dhiyab. The village is about 600 m north-west of Kibbutz Metzer.

In the centre of the hill is the tomb of Sheikh Meisar, adjacent to the mosque. The tomb is in a small square building with a dome and *mikhrab* (prayer niche) apparently from the Middle Ages. All over the upper hilltop there are ruins of walls, quarried places, cisterns, and burial caves. The local people call it Khirbet Hamam (the ruin of the pigeons).

The village does not appear in the Medieval sources or in the Ottoman census of 1596, and was apparently established in the 18<sup>th</sup> or 19<sup>th</sup> centuries.

Sheikh Meisar was renowned for his great holiness. Local traditions (Meron and Kabha 1993: 193ff) mention several explanations for the name Meisar. Local history says that the grandfather of the Abu Raqqieh family left Baqa el-Gharbiyeh, migrated to Qaffin, and settled near the tomb of Sheikh Meisar.

Several salvage excavations have been made in the village. The 1998 excavation of an underground facility by Orbin (2001) revealed a narrow



139. Two architectural remnants of the Roman site at Esh-Sheikh Meisar. Left: Greek inscription on a stone altar. Right: carved capital, Roman (Drawing from photos: S. Haad). The Greek inscription reads: "to the Olympian Zeus, who listens, Oxentius erected". The inscription is dated to the Severan dynasty (193-235 CE) (Appelbaum 1985: no. 1).



square shaft about 1 m deep that leads from the surface level into a central bell-shaped hall (bottom diameter 6 m and height 5.5 m). Remnants of plaster lined the bottom and walls up to a height of 1 m, and in its upper part, where the shaft meets the ceiling, 12 columbaria cells were cut. It seems that the function of the facility, starting in Roman or Byzantine times, was changed several times. It is likely that during the Ottoman era it fell into disuse and became a refuse dump.

In 2002 Dagot (2007) and 'Awawdi (2003) excavated agricultural remains west of the village (Israel grid 1533/2055 and 1542/2058), including traces of quarrying, winepresses, and terraces from the Early Roman period. In another excavation Sa'id (2009) excavated three strata from the Roman-Byzantine periods in the centre of the village (Israel grid 1541/2055). In the lowest layer two quarries of *Nari* stone (caliche or calcrete) were found. At some stage the quarries were filled with earth, and on top were found remains of rooms of three different structures dated to the Roman period. Above these structures wall remains dated to the Late Roman and Byzantine periods were found.

In 2003 Tabar and Gendelman (2013) excavated a bathhouse of the Roman and Byzantine periods and Byzantine dwellings in the outskirts of the village (Israel grid 1543/2055).

Another excavation in the village centre (Israel grid 1541/2042 – Sa'id 2008) found pits dated to the end of the Byzantine period (7<sup>th</sup> century CE), and above it were remains of a residential house from the Abbasid period (9<sup>th</sup>–10<sup>th</sup> centuries CE).

In 2006–2007 an Early Roman pottery kiln was excavated in the village (Massarwa 2010c), together with a Byzantine structure (Israel grid 1543/2057 – Massarwa 2009).

**Pottery:** Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 25%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 5%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 10%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 34.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 115.

Site 103: 15-20/45/1

## Metzer

|                                            |                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1548 2050                     | Soil type: brown forest                         |
| UTM grid: 6926 5911                        | Soil quality: 6                                 |
| Elevation: 85 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.        | Cultivation: none                               |
| Name type: appears on map, but not as site | Cisterns: about 8                               |
| Site type: small ruin                      | Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140), 1 km distant |
| Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)                | Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), next to site            |
| Topography: low hilltop                    | Visibility: 6                                   |
| Rock type: Mount Scopus group              | Date of excavation: 1955-1956                   |

A small site on a broad hilltop, between the western region of Ya'bad Hills and the Sharon Plain. To the east, west and north of the hilltop are flat valleys, among which Wadi Samantar runs. Today the houses of Kibbutz Metzer are situated on the site.

In the years 1955-56 an excavation was carried out by Dothan (1957; 1959; 1993; *NEAEHL* 5: 2102), revealing occupations from the Chalcolithic and Early Bronze Age I periods. Some later *tumuli* were found on top of the deserted buildings.

In Stratum III a large broadhouse was excavated (6×13 m) with its stone foundations, containing a long hall and a room at the end. The entrance was in the long wall on the north side, and the finds included pottery from the Ghassulian culture of the Chalcolithic period. After an interval, two Early Bronze Age I apsidal structures were built on top of the long building. The larger of the two was 5×11 m. A number of stone-lined bell-shaped granaries were excavated, as well as a complete skeleton of a dog. Flint tools and metal tools were also found, among them five copper chisels. In Stratum I the rectangular broad-houses reappeared, but this time from a later stage in the Early Bronze Age I, without the room at the end. Along the walls were built benches, and grey burnished and red-painted vessels were found. Pits cut in the rock were also found with channels leading to them, possibly cisterns for rainwater.

After the site's abandonment, at the end of the Early Bronze Age I, undated *tumuli* tombs were built on the site.

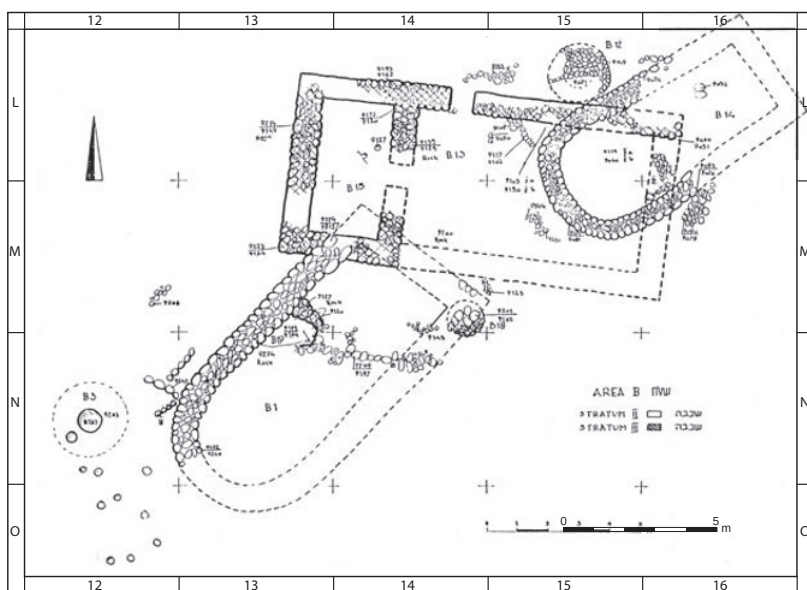
Also found, from later periods, were bell-shaped cisterns, a crude mosaic floor, and many quarried places. Two burial caves, from the Early Roman and Late Roman periods, were excavated by Gophna (1974: 27); both are of

the *loculi* cave type, and each of them contained 13 *loculi*. Apparently this place served as the burial ground of the adjacent settlement at Khirbet Meisar, and possibly also of Umm edh-Dhiyab. In addition, there was agricultural activity on the hill in later periods.

**Pottery:** Chalcolithic – 40%; Early Bronze I – 40%; Roman – 20%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 35.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dayan 1958; Dauphin 1998, III: site 123.



140. Plan of the Chalcolithic-Early Bronze Age I dwellings from the excavations at Metzer (Dothan 1959: fig. 2).

Site 104: 15-20/55/1

### Khirbet Bir el-Isyar (A) (on British Survey map: Kh. Bir Isir)

Israel grid: 1557 2052

UTM grid: 6934 5913

Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: fortified tell

Area: about 40 dunams (4 ha)

Topography: valley fringes

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: Mediterranean brown

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 25

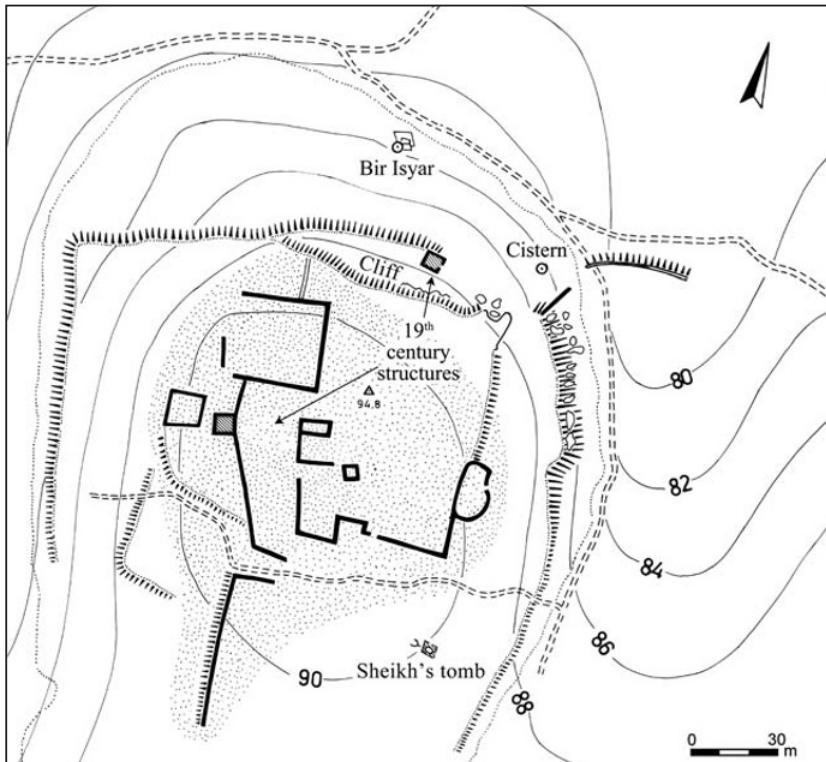
Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
at site

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), next to  
site

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Nov. 1991; 80 sherds

A large tell on the eastern fringes of Marj Qaffin, 1 km east of Kibbutz Metzer. The tell's slopes seclude it from its environs except for the south



141. Plan of the tell of Khirbet Bir el-Isyar, 1999.

side, where it is attached by a low saddle to a plateau.

The tell is built on several steps. On the top part is the upper city ('acropolis'). Remains of a small village from the Late Ottoman period (18<sup>th</sup>–19<sup>th</sup> centuries CE) were found there. Evidently the line of the lower terrace indicates a wall.

On the tell's slopes are many remnants of rock-cut installations and cisterns. North of the tell, in the shade of ancient fig trees, is Bir Isyar – a deep built well, which served as the site's water source. On the southern saddle is the tomb of Sheikh Isyar, which includes a concrete structure and a dome. Most of the sherds were collected in the field to the west of the site.

The British Survey found "foundations, cisterns; a deep well, with cemented troughs round it" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 58).

**Pottery:** Iron I – 2%; Iron II-III – 30%; Persian – 15%; Hellenistic – 7%; Early Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 13%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 7%; Ottoman – 6%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 37.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 117.



Site 105: 15-20/55/2

## Khirbet Bir el-Isyar (B)

Israel grid: 1559 2055

UTM grid: 6937 5916

Elevation: 88 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: Mediterranean brown

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 6

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
at site

Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), at site

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Oct. 1991; 22 sherds

A ruin on a hilltop in the western fringes of the Qaffin Valley. It is north-east of Khirbet Bir el-Isyar (A), and between the two sites is a small valley in which is the spouting well of Bir Isyar.

There are many remains here, built of uncut field stones. Courtyards,

lanes, dwelling places and many quarryings, cisterns, and installations.

Ne'eman (1990: site 38) recorded finding an "agricultural farm" here, but this is inconsistent with the evidence. This is a village typical of the Byzantine-Early Moslem and Ottoman periods. The site was apparently deserted before the end of the 19<sup>th</sup> century AD, since it is not mentioned in the British Survey.

East of the site Ne'eman (1990: site 39) noted two rock-cut cisterns (Israel grid 1562/2056), and at the foot of the northern slope quarrying and winepress remains. Byzantine sherds were gathered here.

**Pottery:** Byzantine – 40%; Early Moslem – 15%; Middle Ages – 15%; Ottoman – 30%.

**Previous surveys:** Ne'eman 1990: site 38.



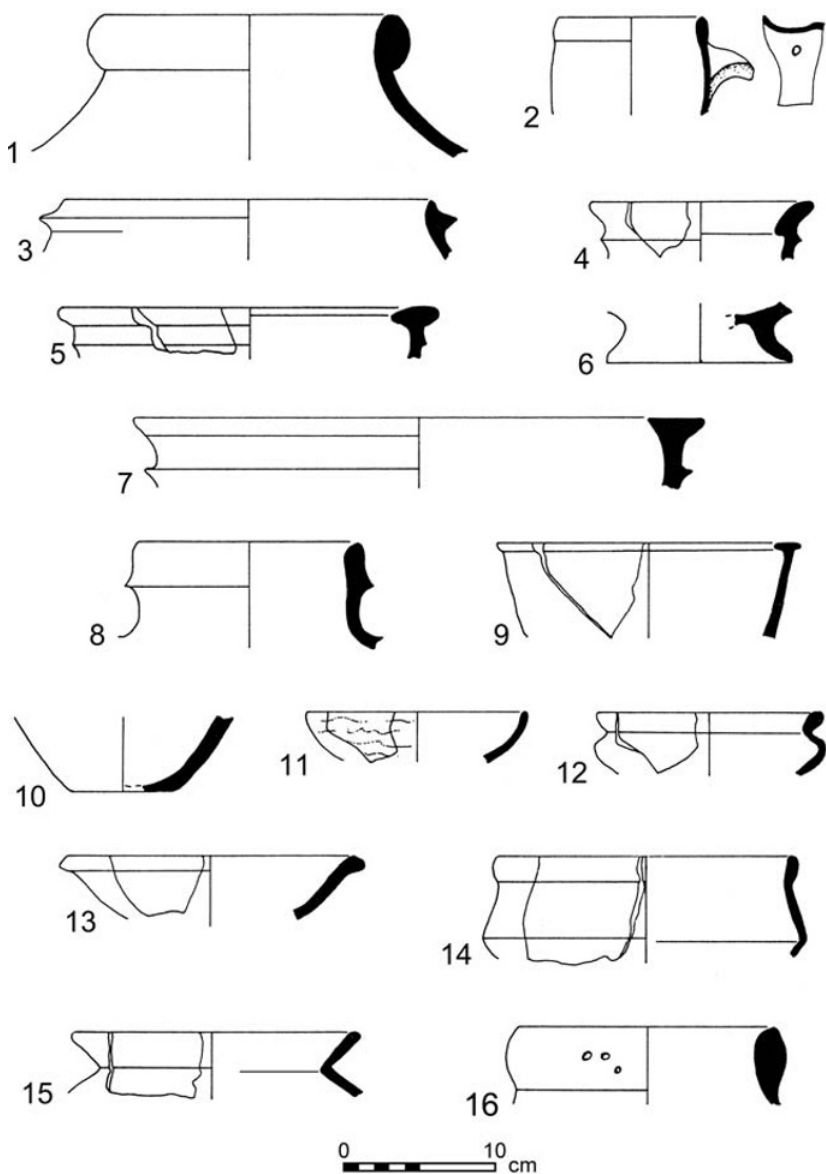
Site 106: 15-20/75/1

## Abu Rujman

|                                      |                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Israel grid: 1576 2055               | Soil quality: 5                                      |
| UTM grid: 6954 5915                  | Cultivation: orchards                                |
| Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a. | Cisterns: 6                                          |
| Name type: ancient, but not on map   | Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),<br>1.8 km distant |
| Site type: large ruin                | Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), 1.5 km<br>distant            |
| Area: about 25 dunams (2.5 ha)       | Visibility: 4                                        |
| Topography: moderate ridge           | Dates of visit: Oct. 1991; 100 sherds                |
| Rock type: Mount Scopus group        |                                                      |
| Soil type: terra rossa               |                                                      |

A large site on a moderate ridge planted with olive trees, between the village of Qaffin to the south and Khirbet 'Aqqabeh to the north. The ridge slopes down from east to west, and the site extends over its eastern and central parts. A sharp slope descends to the north, and a moderate one to the south.

In the upper core are three very large piles of building stones. In the central pile there are built terraces in which building stones are integrated. Among the terraces is a considerable sherd scatter, and in several places openings of cisterns are visible.



142. Pottery from Abu Rujman: 1.Pithos, dk, IA I; 2.Jug, yel, IA I; 3.CP, dk brn, IA Ib; 4.Jar, yel, MB II; 5, 7.Kraters, lt, MB II; 6.Jug base, lt, LB; 8, 16.Pithoi, brn, IA I; 9.Bowl, gr, IA I; 10.Jug base, gr, IA I; 11.Bowl, rd on lt, IA II; 12.Bowl, brn, IA I; 13.Bowl, lt, MB II; 14.Bowl, brn, IA I; 15.Bowl, lt, MB II.

No remains of fortifications are discernible, and it is difficult to determine the boundary of the settlement. On the west side are many remains of walls. On the east side are patches of scattered sherds, especially from Iron Age I. There are also many quarried places, burial caves and installations.

According to the British Survey there are only "foundations" on the site (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 57).

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze IIb – 9%; Late Bronze – 7%; Iron I – 70%; Iron II – 10%; Byzantine – 4%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



Site 107: 15-20/75/2

## Khallet er-Rumman

Israel grid: 1577 2056

UTM grid: 6955 5917

Elevation: 109 m a.s.l., 25 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1.2 dunams (1200 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2 km distant

Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Oct. 1991; 17 sherds

A small site in an inner ravine (Khallet er-Rumman), between the village of Qaffin in the south and Khirbet 'Aqqabeh in the north. The ravine branches off from Wadi Khallet Rageb, and it is situated about 300 m south of Khirbet 'Aqqabeh.

Traces of at least three houses, 5×7 m on the average, were found here, with a sherd scatter near them. The masonry is of very large uncut stones. Apparently this site was founded and existed at the same time as the large site of neighbouring Abu Rujman, as an extension or subsidiary site.

**Pottery:** Iron Ic – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



Site 108: 15-20/75/3

## Khirbet 'Aqqabeh

Israel grid: 1578 2060

UTM grid: 6956 5921

Elevation: 127 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: village on medium-sized ruin

Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 27

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2.2 km distant

Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Dec. 1981; 40 sherds

A ruin on a high hilltop in the hilly area about 1.2 km north of Qaffin. The hilltop comprises the eastern part of Abu Rujman; with good observation eastward and westward.

About six family houses now stand on the hilltop, but among them many ancient ruins are visible: sections of walls, burial caves, rock-cut installations, etc. Four large dwelling caves were found, in which shepherds lived both before and after the modern village was founded.



143. Khirbet 'Aqqabeh, facing east, 1981. Photo: A. Zertal.

The hilltop is surrounded by a rampart, which possibly served for fortification. Middle Bronze Age II pottery may indicate a settlement similar to that of nearby Khirbet Mas'ud.

The place is absent from the Medieval and Ottoman sources and the British Survey. The village seems to be relatively new, apparently founded by people who left Qaffin.

Ne'eman (1990: site 40), who surveyed the region in the 1970s, describes only three caves, alongside a winepress, cisterns, and architectural elements.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze II – 10%; Iron I – 15%; Iron II – 22%; Persian – 14%; Hellenistic – 5%; Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 9%.

**Previous surveys:** Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 12; Ne'eman 1990: site 40.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 111; Salem 2006: site 26.



Site 109: 15-20/85/1

## El-Beiyadha

Israel grid: 1581 2056

UTM grid: 6958 5917

Elevation: 146 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: orchards

Cisterns: 3

Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140),  
2.5 km distant

Road: Baqa-'Arah (C14), 2.3 km  
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Oct. 1991; 20 sherds

A structure on a high hilltop south-east of Khirbet 'Aqqabeh, in the hilly area north of the village of Qaffin.

There are remains of a building, 6×10 m, now covered by piles of cleared stones. The outline of the walls, made of cut masonry, is visible. Next to the structure are three or four quarried places, apparently burial cave openings or clogged cisterns. On the slopes to the west and north are terraces.

**Pottery:** Iron II – 10%; Persian – 70%; Byzantine – 20%.

**Previous surveys:** None.

Site 110: 16-20/05/1

## Khirbet Mas'ud

Israel grid: 1605 2053

UTM grid: 6982 5915

Elevation: 262 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and appears on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: about 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: olives (partial)

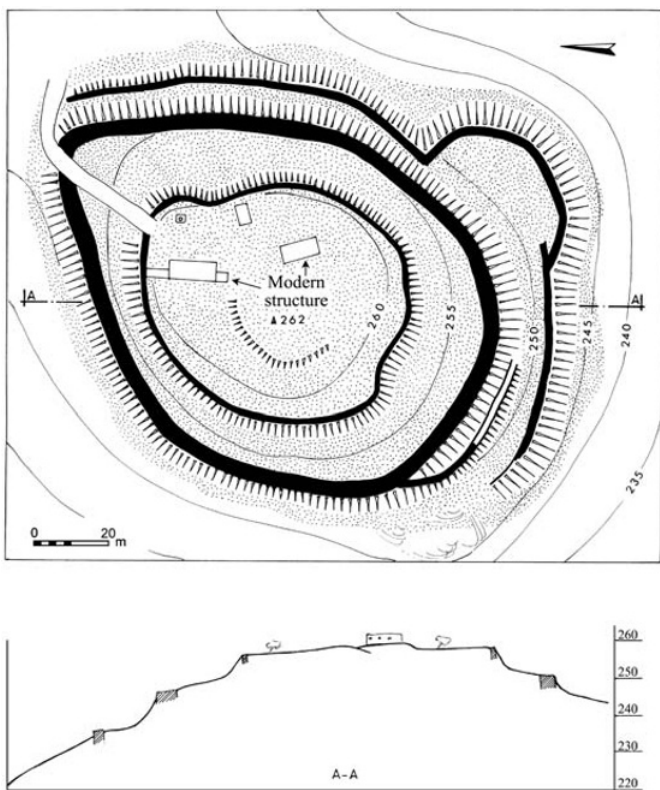
Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20), 4 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Sept. 1997; 54 sherds



144. Plan and cross-section of Khirbet Mas'ud, 1998. Presumably the fortifications were built during the Middle Bronze Age II.

A fortified tell on a high prominent hilltop north of Wadi Ghamiq, about 2.5 km south-west of the village of Zibdeh.

The tell is situated on E.P. 262, at the edge of a steep ridge descending south-west into Wadi Ghamiq. The hilltop is connected via a saddle from the east, and today there are two family houses about 100 years old on the tell. There is excellent observation over the whole hilly area west to the Mediterranean Sea, north to the Qatzir Range, and south to Şeida.

On the slope of the natural hilltop are three lines of fortifications, including thick walls with built earthen ramparts descending from them. The lowest line includes a 2 m thick stone wall and a 3–5 m high rampart descending from it. Above it is the central fortification line, which also has a clearly discernible thick wall, 4 m wide, and a rampart 5–6 m high. The wall in the upper line is 1 m wide, and the earthen rampart descending from it is 4–5 m high. The upper section of the tell creates a flattened area 3 dunams (3000 sq. m) in area, and it can be assumed that this was the upper fortified area with houses standing between the walls. On the south-east part of the fortification line is a round built 'plaza', delineated by large stones.

In the middle of the north-eastern saddle there is a built road, by which the site was reached. On the adjacent hill to the north-west other sections of this road were detected. On the upper surface there are new cisterns.

The place does not appear in the British Survey. In the Emergency Sur-



145. Bird's-eye view of Khirbet Mas'ud, looking north, 1998. Photo: M. Weinberg.

vey Gophna and Porath (1972: site 13) describe “a small tell on a hilltop, with an area of 2.5 dunams. In the centre of the tell is an exposed rock in which there are cisterns. At the summit of the tell a section of crude mosaic has been preserved, apparently the remains of an installation.”

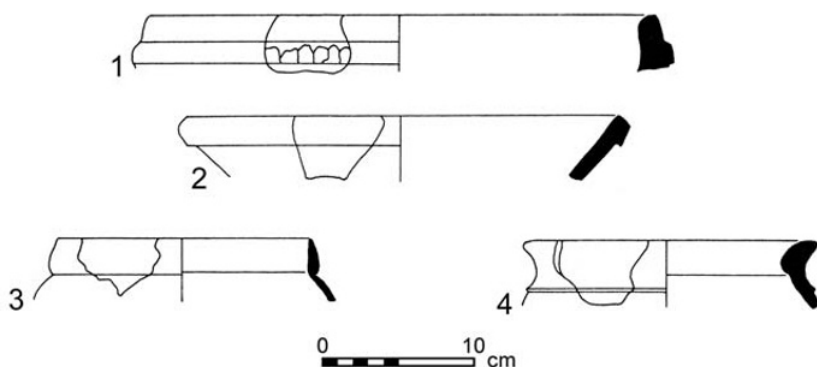
Miller (2000: site 7) who surveyed here in 1996, noted a rock-cut burial cave and sherds (in addition to the finds of the Manasseh Hill Country Survey) from the Iron Age II, Hellenistic, Byzantine/Umayyad, and Modern periods.

Khirbet Mas'ud is an example of a small, fortified tell of Middle Bronze Age II in the internal Samaria hill country that appears to be some sort of fortress (see a corresponding one at Tel Umm Zeid, no. 53). It is possible that these sites were built to guard the territory: all the components of Middle Bronze Age II fortification are found in them in miniature.

**Pottery:** Middle Bronze IIb – 80%; Iron – 5%; Persian – 5%; Early Roman – 10%.

**Previous surveys:** Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 13.

**Additional Bibliography:** Dauphin 1998, III: site 119; Salem 2006: site 190.



146. Pottery from Khirbet Mas'ud: 1.CP, dk, MB II; 2.Bowl, gr, Pers; 3.Krater, yel, MB II; 4.Jar, lt, MB II.

Site 111: 16-20/25/1

## E.P. 285

Israel grid: 1625 2057

UTM grid: 7002 5919

Elevation: 285 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: ancient industrial area

Area: 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 4

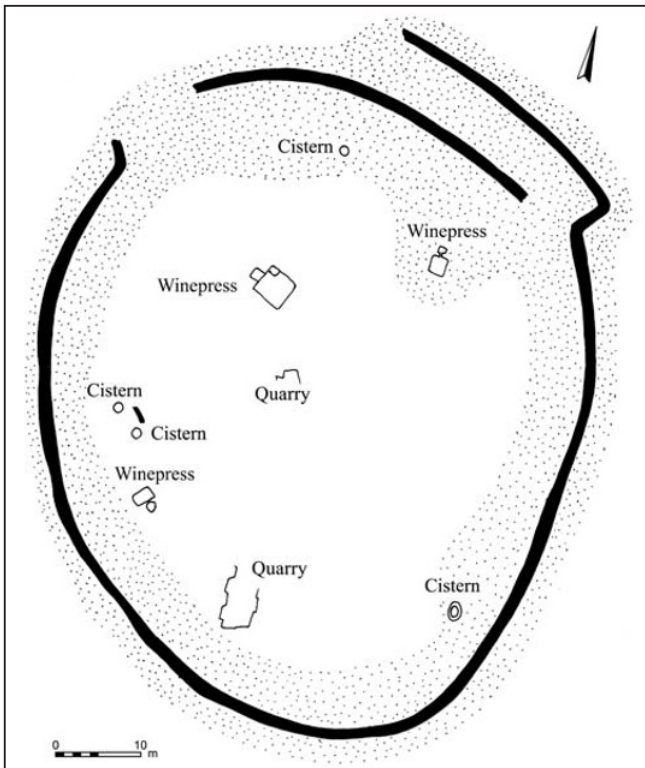
Water source: Bir ej-Jamal (no. 32),  
3.5 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 7

Date of visit: June 1997; 36 sherds

A site on a rocky hilltop in the hilly area west of Ya'bad, about 500 m south



147. Plan of the site at E.P. 285, 1997. This site seems to have been a centre for agricultural production.

of the village of Zibdeh.

The hilltop is encircled by a 1 m-thick wall built of medium-sized stones. It surrounds an elliptical area, about 40×60 m. Along the wall on the inside is a levelled area about 6–7 m wide that apparently served as a pathway. The entrance, on the north-eastern side, was reached by a built road from the north. In this area a 6 m-wide opening is visible, rising to the road surrounding the site. The inner part of the hilltop is made of soft limestone, with many areas of quarrying; a large, public winepress, 5×5 m with a vat (1.8×1.8 m and 2 m deep), two small winepresses, water cisterns, and openings of caves. It appears that the above served as an 'industrial zone' for wine production in the Roman-Byzantine period. The path surrounding it served to reach the installations.

About 300 m north-east of this area are a large house, a courtyard, and installations, probably from the Ottoman period, in a state of advanced deterioration. The roof was supported by stone arches, of which one roof support and pieces of plaster remain *in situ*. Next to it are rock-cut installations.

**Pottery:** Late Roman – 50%; Byzantine – 50%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



Site 112: 16-20/35/1

## Dhahret el-Budru

Israel grid: 1633 2052

UTM grid: 7011 5914

Elevation: 290 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa and brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Water source: Bir ej-Jamal (no. 32), 2.5 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Nov. 1978; 22 sherds

A farm on a hilltop on an elongated ridge (Dhahret el-Budru). It is located in the area of low hills north-west of the Dothan Valley, near the road from

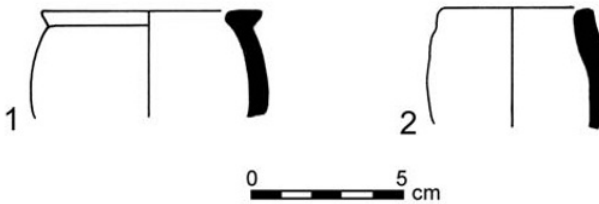


Ya'bad to Barṭa'ah, and about 1.5 km south-east of Zibdeh.

On the hilltop are structural remains, and in the middle of them is a building of uncut field stones, which includes a large courtyard, 15×20 m, and traces of several rooms around it. About 25 m east of the farm are rock-cut installations and cisterns.

**Pottery:** Byzantine – 100%.

**Previous surveys:** None.



148. Pottery from Dhahret el-Budru: 1, 2. Jars, brn, Byz.



Site 113: 16-20/45/2

## Tell el-'Abeideh

Israel grid: 1641 2058

UTM grid: 7019 5920

Elevation: 319 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 48 dunams (4.8 ha)

Topography: large hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 30

Water source: Bir Jamal (no. 32),  
1.8 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km  
distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visits: 1979-80, June 1997  
(plan); 112 sherds

A large, fortified tell on a large high hilltop, about 2 km west of Ya'bad, in the hilly area north-west of the Dothan Valley. The tell's slopes descend sharply to the north towards Wadi Lihf el-Azghar, and to the east. The tell is conveniently attached to Ya'bad Range in the south and south-west, while its south side is exposed and deeply eroded.